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Toh 382 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 382 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture belonging to the class of highest yoga tantra, known in Tibetan as a section treating the profound esoteric doctrine of bindus — subtle drops or essential points — within the context of the self-arisen deity and the great elements. The text opens with the bodhisattva Vajragarbha and other great beings making offerings and prostrating before the Blessed One, then posing questions in verse about the nature of the self-arisen, its relation to the supreme deity, and the inner meaning of union with all buddhas, situating it within the genre of dialogic tantric revelation. While a distinct Sanskrit title is not clearly determinable from the available material, the scripture is framed as a teaching on the deepest secret of nondual bliss and the central element understood through inference. The colophon notes that the translation was written after Kongba examined and made revisions, indicating it passed through a phase of editorial refinement characteristic of later canonical transmission in Tibet.

Written after Kongba examined and made revisions.

Then the bodhisattvas, the great beings, headed by Vajragarbha, made further offerings, prostrated, and spoke these words:

If you would explain, settling the matter clearly,
the meaning of bindus within bindus,
then since the self-arisen dwells at my center,
let that self-arisen be spoken of.

The word "self-arisen" — so called — pertains to the great elements,
and is to be understood by inference.

This self-arisen Blessed One
is the singular supreme deity.

As for "supreme deity" —
those are the elements spoken of above.
Among them the central one is supremely excellent,
as expressed through the form of the primary lord.

In the supreme secret delight,
the self of all forever abides.

In what way, O Blessed One, does
union with all buddhas,
the binding of the ḍākinī net —
in what way does this form of vow
serve as a supremely beneficial vow?

The word "secret" is itself endowed with qualities;
"secret" too is proclaimed to be a quality.
Vajra-possessing is endowed with qualities.
It is praised by those who take supreme delight in the world, and blame is
abandoned.

The word "secret" is a language of the outcast peoples;
even when sought externally,
this is to be known by direct perception,
by inference, and by the word of the qualified.

When mind cannot be seen —
this very thing called "mind"
is said to be both the qualified and the qualities.

In the supreme secret delight,
the self of all forever abides.

In this secret, the nature of reality abides.
With respect to that, the self of all —
that is where all things fully reside.

Whatever is the empty vajra-holder
rejoices together with bliss.

When, through the form of mind,
blue and other colors are not apprehended by the eye,
and when sounds and such are not heard by the ear —
then what is mind?

Then what is inference?

If this is not apprehended by the nose,
does fragrance dwell at the center or not?
Mind does not apprehend externally,
nor is there likewise any proximate enjoyment.
Taste is neither sweet nor pungent.
Likewise too with what is tangible.

In the supreme secret delight,
the self of all forever abides.

How, then, is this secret
to be contemplated through inference?

Just as wisdom itself
has gone into the form of letters —
in what other way is the word "Blessed One"?
What is meant by the word "deity"?
What is the definitive meaning of all buddhas?
What is to be called "union"?
What name belongs to the *ḍākinī*?
What sort of thing is the net?
What is called the vow?

And likewise, what is difficult to practice?
What did you mean when you spoke of no attachment?
And equally, what of the one without desire?
What name does "the Middle Way" belong to?
What is the illusion of all women?
Emptiness, the form realm and so forth —
what is explained and how is equality applied?

The first: six-fold transformation;
the varied lotus-painted body;
the great *mudrā* of *Āli* and *Kāli*;
the yoga of mind free of suchness;
and how is suchness good?
Meditative equipoise in yoga itself,
and the outer, though fierce, is rightly explained.
Moon, sun, perfect buddha —
what sort of arising is this?
Drawn and undrawn —
how are *maṇḍalas* to be established?
Likewise mantra, tantra itself,
the secret place — I do not understand —
and the four lotuses in particular:
how are self and what belongs to self?
Likewise mind and mental factors;
the essential nature of mind is said to be gnosis.

Likewise consciousness itself,
the things that are causes and results,
and likewise phenomena and their possessors —
what is called the stream of a river?
The ocean, too, is distinguished.
If you teach variety,
how will the many not be obtained?
You have spoken of consciousness and gnosis —

Likewise, what is the nature of taking the essence, the stretching out to the left and so forth? Likewise, what is the victory-bow and what else belongs to it? What is the sound of "principal" and "non-principal"? And what is said to be examination? The Dharma factors of great awakening — the thirty-seven inner ones and the bodies and so forth and what else is like them — what does your teaching of them to śrāvakas intend, and what is the purpose of that? What does the yoga of the form of great bliss of Vajrasattva accomplish? Brahmā, Īśvara, and Viṣṇu — likewise, what is the meaning of the petition to them? The god of desire together with his consort, the goddess Durgatipraśamanī who possesses the dhāraṇī — she who formerly went for refuge — the union of the two together, the maker of pleasure: what is this union-combat, and what is the secret of it? The Vajra-Bearer spoke these things as falsehood, yet afterward expressed them in words. Buddha, Vajrasattva, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Īśvara, and the Moon — previously taught differently — all of these dwell forever as a single self. How is it that the Vajra-Bearer is peaceful, and how is it that he has a wrathful form? What is the dharmakāya? What is the sambhogakāya? How does the emanation arise as vajra itself, and how is Heruka explained? How is Padma the Lord of Dance? How does he take the form of Yama? Likewise, what of the supreme horse itself — how is it spoken of by rite, and what is said? Likewise the goddess and the wrathful one — what you have explained of the outcaste — what is the purpose of that? For now, how were the words of the goddesses collected? O Vajrasattva, you who speak of mantra — explain all of these correctly and completely.

The Blessed One declared: beginning with "Thus did I hear" and so forth, composed first, it recurs here as well, and it is to be spoken, O son of the lineage. The word "secret" has seven aspects; "seventh" means the seventh. The eighth is characterized by the inexpressible. By the word "secret" is meant the non-duality of mind and mental factors — this is said to be the Tathāgata

itself. Because it has one taste and one essential nature in suchness, it is hidden there — hence "secret." Pervading all of space is the measure of the Blessed One; dwelling therein is the gnosis-mudrā of glorious Vajrasattva and so forth, together with the vajra-goddesses. O Blessed One, what is the supremely distinguished abode?

The Blessed One declared: "Supreme" means supremely distinguished — it is the domain of sacred primordial wisdom. "Where there is delight" means where there is experiential joy, free from all analogy. Through perfect union with the eyes and so forth, one makes joy arise — therefore it is called "where there is delight." Through the union of glorious Vajrasattva and going together with all the goddesses, extending to the ends of the expanse of space, in the great bliss of all the goddesses — the power arising from this union possessing the bliss of all unions is immeasurable. Rejoicing mutually and giving rise to joy: the joy of men and their delight is "where there is delight." "The self of all" means the self of all things. O son of the lineage, in this way the Blessed One has taught the abode as stated before. Therefore it is taught as the self of all Tathāgatas — "the self of all" is that which was taught. Thus being so, "the self of all" expresses the excellence of the abode. As declared, by the nature of generating each in the abode as spoken, he dwells forever in the midst of however many retinues of queens. The buddhas and all these buddhas — all buddhas —

equal to the number of the finest particles of dust in all world-systems. The quality of permanence and so forth — because it is made by those Tathāgatas, or because it is their intrinsic nature, the abode is called "the very substance of all buddhas" — substance here meaning the illusory or intrinsic nature. "Hero" — because of the capacity to act for the benefit of sentient beings. "Vajra" — because it is of the intrinsic nature of the wisdom of skillful means and wisdom-discernment. "Hero" — because it is unmoved by all conceptual thought. "Bliss" — because, from the union of joy spoken of before, it is greatly endowed with the nature of a mind that is utterly at peace. "Supreme" means especially exalted. This is said to express the ultimate excellence of these heroes dwelling in these stations of bliss.

Nevertheless, the line "the union of all buddhas and the vow of the ḍākinī web" is not desired in that sense. Rather, in order to speak of it in a different way, taking up what might be doubted, the Blessed One declared: the words "this, then" — that is to say, O son of the lineage, what was spoken there is precisely that same thing — "the union of all buddhas and the vow of the ḍākinī web" —

that is the meaning. Surrounded by all the goddesses and, with the yoga of the identity of the glorious Vajrasattva complete, that is good fortune — to be supremely attached, endowed with supreme desire, in the accomplishment of the very practice of one's own identity. Being free of male dancers, dwelling within the retinue of one's own queens, with the mind utterly undistracted from what is meaningful, one should experience the bliss of true union with the goddesses. "True union" — that is yoga, it is said.

Steadiness, permanence, and ultimate contentment of mind. Or: "steadiness" — because one is not shaken by the winds of conceptual thought. Furthermore, "permanence" — because one abides to the very boundary of all extremes. "Ultimate contentment of mind" — because one directly experiences the bliss of all the goddesses. Steadiness, permanence, and ultimate contentment of mind — these are steadiness, permanence, and ultimate contentment of mind.

"All buddhas" refers to form, sound, smell, taste, and touch — the intrinsic natures of sense-objects. When one's own merit accumulation is in harmony as cause, what does one do? One makes use of what is one's own enjoyment and one consumes these. Otherwise, in a separate thing, it would not be experience that is one's own. The primordially born intrinsic nature of wisdom is not abandoned even by the Victors. Whatever within the intrinsic nature of the graduated union of various stages of practice — the conduct of desire and so forth — whatever is desired from the conduct of desire, those are desired as the ritual of Vajrasattva. Those whose intrinsic nature is excellent desire the siddhi of Vairocana. Similarly, those who conduct themselves in aversion, desire, miserliness, and laziness come to desire the rituals of Heruka, the Lord of the Lotus Dance, Vajrasūrya, and the Supreme Horse.

O son of the lineage, in just such a way, having generated how adverse conditions such as conduct in desire and so forth generate the glorious Vajrasattva and others, and having produced them from the yoga of the feast-maṇḍala, one tames disciples with the discourse of yoga. Discourse means declaration.

"What kind of discourse, O Blessed One?" The Blessed One declared: it is the discourse called "secret" and so forth — expressed in the manner of conventional truth.

Because it accords with the cause of the dharmakāya of the glorious Vajrasattva, and in order to engage in proximity to the intrinsic nature of the

essential-nature body (svabhāvakāya), the glorious Vajrasattva and the others are generated. The intrinsic nature is to be declared.

"Firm" means firm like the Dharma-Mount Meru. By way of example, Mount Meru is difficult to turn back by the wind, and even the most violent storm cannot move it. In just the same way, this Blessed One, the glorious Vajrasattva, cannot be moved or displaced by the mental afflictions such as attachment and so forth, by the secondary afflictions, or by the ferocious and crushing assaults of malevolent non-Buddhists. Though dwelling in the charnel ground, he courses through the mindstreams of all sentient beings; the purified mind follows him through many gateways of the Dharma; and together with this, the Blessed One dwells within saṃsāra.

"Firm" refers to the aspect of stability. "Moving" is to be understood as grasped from within the mindstreams of sentient beings — these are to be known by the Blessed One. In the way that those who are the very selves of purification are of one form with others in their essential nature, for that very reason this Blessed One dwells within the minds of all the Tathāgatas. Sentient beings, too, are all Tathāgatas; because they abide in the ultimate reality of things, they are called Tathāgatas. "Moving" is like a monkey, and because one who stabilizes the minds of all sentient beings is called a bodhisattva, and because of that holding, it is samādhi (meditative absorption), and through discernment it becomes vajra itself. Therefore, mind alone is declared to be the very nature of movement, and not exterior phenomena and the like, for those are without substantial existence by way of either unity or multiplicity.

"All" means without exception. "Thing" means the meaning of abiding. "Existence" means birth. "The firm and the moving" means the firm and the moving. "Things and all" means all things; and that encompasses all the firm and the moving — things and existence. The intrinsic nature of all things both firm and moving is this: whatever is the intrinsic nature of the self of all is the self of all things both firm and moving. For that very reason, the Blessed One who holds the vajra spoke this vajra-word:

By the nature of reality (dharmatā) of the mind of Vajrasattva, which is the self of all things both firm and moving, that which will express these matters — the utterly pure dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena — is gathered together through the mirror-like wisdom and the rest, and all the splendors of the five buddhas — Akṣobhya and the others, the permanent and the immovable — are fully gathered.

The word "all" is to be taken as meaning "completely." "Union" means coming together. Where? In the secret — as the very self, the source of all phenomena, and nowhere else. Together with whom? With the Blessed One Vajrasattva — together with him through the nine aspects: his own true essential nature, emanation, and the rest. Yet through the single body that he manifests as the perfect sambhogakāya, everything from every direction converges on the self of that, like water and milk, and is fully held. Then, through the yoga of the great maṇḍala, within all outer and inner things, in that very instant, just as all buddhas have performed it, one realizes and knows it. Therefore the union together with all the buddhas and with those other than them is the union with all the buddhas. The time of union is the time of indivisibility.

Through the place of union, by entering into meditative equipoise in mind-only for all of that, things that have become unified mutually gather one another in; and since, through the intrinsic nature of all things, one proceeds everywhere, this is called "union with all buddhas." Therefore, through union with all buddhas, this — the perfect seeing of beings throughout the expanse of the ten directions — is declared to be the dākinī of union with all buddhas.

The word "net" is to be understood as a synonym for illusion. Just as illusory conjured elephants and the like arise from wood and other materials, so the Tathāgatas — Akṣobhya and the rest — do not abandon sentient beings who are to be tamed without form, and this is why.

Through contact with the form of Vajradevī and the other goddesses — the white one and the rest — one becomes that very reality, and by the illusory characteristic of union with all buddhas, whatever Tathāgata is stilled in mind through undefiled bliss becomes the many Tathāgatas.

Then one should recite by means of the word of the vow. The syllable "sam" means bliss. The word "bar" means "supremely excellent." "All women" has been explained above. "Illusion" is as it has been declared — meaning: "by illusion, through that very nature of illusion." This too is established by its intrinsic nature, and what is established is what is complete. How does one's own essential nature undergo full transformation? One's own form, and the form belonging to them — these are one's own form: the all-base consciousness (ālayavijñāna), the afflicted consciousness (kliṣṭamānas), the mentation (manas), and the consciousnesses of the eye, ear, nose, tongue, and body — the full transformation of all these is the full transformation

through one's own essential nature. Through cultivation in the meditative absorption of selflessness, resting in the intrinsic nature of mirror-like wisdom, the wisdom of equality, discerning wisdom, and all-accomplishing wisdom, one undergoes transformation — that is the meaning. Since through the full transformation of one's own essential nature one obtains the illusory-natured attainment of all women, therefore:

Through the blissful delight of all that is gained,
all women come to be accomplished.

"Variegated" and "illusion" together make "variegated illusion" — forms of various colors and shapes, such as the forms of all the goddesses and the rest. Having taken up this mudrā of variegated illusion and fixed it in the mind, the following was declared: O ḍākinī, that which proceeds throughout the expanse of the ten directions, having entered into the retinue of queens — that is the Blessed One Vajrasattva himself — this is the meaning of the phrase "the mudrā of variegated illusion." What is widely renowned in all the treatises of the world and beyond the world yet is expressed in an obscure language through its own coded signs — that too is the meaning. "Ḍākinī" and the rest: all this has been stated in summary.

Since all women are the Blessed One's vajra goddesses, abiding in the eight aspects of the all-base consciousness and the rest — the consciousnesses that perpetuate saṃsāra — and undergoing transformation, they are accomplished through the illusory nature of the four wisdoms: mirror-like wisdom, the wisdom of equality, discerning wisdom, and all-accomplishing wisdom, by reason of that characteristic of transformation. The mirror-like wisdom and the rest belonging to these are the essential natures of variegated illusion; and their activity through illusion is the moving through space, which manifests as variegated form. Therefore this mudrā of variegated illusion is to be spoken of as "ḍākinī." The barbarians' speaking of it as ḍākinī merely on account of their moving through the sky alone is not what is meant. As it is said:

Accomplished in ranging through all of space —
that is why she is celebrated as ḍākinī.

That, then, is the explanation.

"From all" refers to the ten directions. "Variegated" and its mudrā is the variegated mudrā — the mudrā of the eyes and so forth. Because through the yoga of reflections one seals the constitutions of sentient beings, it is therefore spoken of as "mudrā." "Variegated" means the intrinsic nature of all things, or

the glorious Vajrasattva together with all things, and the mudrā is the variegated mudrā. "By the variegated vow gathered from all" means of variegated aspects: she whose nature is to move through all of space by supreme bliss is the ḍākinī.

"The expanse of buddhas' speech" — abiding in the glorious buddha Vairocana and being reflected back therefrom are the natural constituent elements: the natural constituent elements of the body, speech, and mind of all Tathāgatas are expressed by the term "expanse of buddhas' speech." Just as the causes of being reflected back while abiding in the glorious Vajrasattva are the natural constituent elements of that one, so by the term "ḍākinī" the nature of moving through space is indicated. In the same way, this is to be understood with respect to the constituent elements of Vairocana, Akṣobhya, Ratnādhīpa, Amitābha, and Amoghasiddhi.

"The ḍākinī of all buddhas" — all those who move through space surrounding the Blessed One Vajrasattva with eyes and so forth are ḍākinīs of the nature of Vajrasattva. Likewise, all those who move through space surrounding the glorious Heruka together with the white one and so forth are ḍākinīs of the nature of Heruka. Likewise, all those who move through space surrounding the one endowed with the yoga of Nairātmyā together with Vajradevī and so forth, along with the ḍākinīs of the nature of selflessness. Likewise, all those who move through space surrounding the one endowed with primordial wisdom together with Vajraḍākinī and so forth are ḍākinīs endowed with the nature of primordial wisdom. In the same way, together with Tārā: those together with Padmāvatī, the Lotus Wheel, the King of Yama, likewise Hayagrīva, and likewise the very Victor over the three worlds — and moreover, whatever else is wished for in mind, differentiated by classification of lineage, is said to be surrounded in the same way by ḍākinīs.

Having thus set forth the ḍākinīs of all buddhas, and in order to explain the vow, "bliss" means: that which, through union with the wisdom-mudrā of the Blessed One, the glorious Vajrasattva, generates in one something possessing supreme bliss. What arises from that? "Supreme" means especially distinguished, because it is the most excellent means of all bliss. For that very reason it is the engagement with all illusion. This also means that it is not through union with śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas in any other way. That which generates bliss through union in the very way of the network of ḍākinīs — the union with all buddhas — is expressed by the syllable "saṃ." Therefore, that which, through that cause, generates supreme, especially distinguished

bliss, by realizing all those illusory phenomena that are the purified aspect of the nirvāṇa of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, great compassion arises.

"Not empty" — because the three realms and all objects of desire are entities falsely imagined in their falseness, they are not empty of falsely imagined entities that are falsely imagined therein, since they are indeed entities.

"Not empty" — and "not" means that ultimately there are no entities of conceptual thought that apprehend and grasp as subject and object. The wisdom by which the absence of those entities of apprehended and apprehender is made directly perceived — that wisdom itself also does not become an object of focus, because it is not within the domain of conceptual thought. For that very reason, the meaning of what is said is: "It is to be understood as the Middle Way of authentic wisdom." And it is said, "Joined with the Perfection of Wisdom" — the skillful means for that very reason is great compassion.

The object of focus that is the very nature of compassion belonging to the awakened buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is the intrinsic nature of compassion. Then "the beautiful compassion-method" means compassion that is exceedingly beautiful — the great compassion that focuses on nothing, through equanimity. That very skillful means — this method endowed with exceedingly beautiful compassion — is the nature of non-abiding nirvāṇa (Skt. apratiṣṭhitanirvāṇa): this is the glorious Vairocana. When asked what it becomes, one connects it with the statement "the arising of pure phenomena."

When asked how the Perfection of Wisdom illumines authentically: "Wisdom" means one should investigate through discriminating analysis that divides phenomena as if they were illusions — that itself is the excellence of the self. "Perfection" means it teaches the crossing over — thus it is declared: "the illumination of the Perfection of Wisdom."

By whom? It is "through aspiring faith free of conceptual thought." What does it do? The intention is expressed in the words "previously, from the capacity of the master." What was analyzed? "All that was analyzed" means the essential nature of form and so forth as being illusory, in their own independent manner. From what characteristics does one cling? "In phenomena free of conceptual thought, the aim of sentient beings is thoroughly analyzed" — this means: analyzed through the force of compassion, with the benefit of sentient beings as its cause.

When asked what becomes of that analysis: as for the word "echo" in "equanimity, like an echo" — an echo is the sound of a valley. By that, it is equal to the most excellent sound, following along in equal resonance, and the nature of conceptually elaborated sound; and through the Perfection of Wisdom one conceives of that as being like an echo, having become just so.

When asked what that is: "Then from that, this Dharma-speech arose" — meaning, from that, on account of that, from the Dharma, the distinctive words of certainty regarding the meaning of the Dharma appearing individually and known individually are the nature of what has been analyzed. For that very reason, this illumines the three pledges (Skt. samaya) of the glorious Vairocana and others.

The Dharma of speech means the melody of speech. That it has become so means it opens the voice, and this speech of voice is expressed in just that way accordingly. And that which is established from what is not authentic is established from the Dharma-speech. "Vehicle" and "great" together form the Great Vehicle — the path of bodhisattvas together with its fruit. It is established as great through being connected with the seven aspects of greatness in the sūtras of the Perfection of Wisdom and so forth.

Therefore, the especially distinguished vajra vehicle, which is the Great Vehicle, is for the purpose of realizing in this very life buddhahood and so forth — and so its qualities have become supreme: powers, fearlessness, and the like. The accumulation of these is vast, precisely because those are qualities become supreme. The three times are: the past, the future, and the present. The three pledges means everything of the nature of body, speech, and mind. All Tathāgatas are Vairocana and so forth. When asked how the praise is expressed: through the reasoning of reflections and so forth, free of conceptual thought and liberated, all Tathāgatas are praised.

Because emptiness by its very nature pervades all things without exception — the stable and the moving alike — and because that stability and movement and so forth are pervaded by it, the three realms are nothing but mere consciousness (vijñaptimātra). Therefore vows and the like are taught as divine yoga.

The Blessed One was then asked: "Blessed One, for what reason can worldly beings not realize the nature of that — that is, everything just as it is, in its own aspect?"

The Blessed One declared: "The word 'because' is the reason. 'Everything, as its very self' means: by the actuality of everything. 'As its own self' means: as belonging to itself. 'Dwelling in the aggregate of consciousness' means: in that which is the body of consciousness. 'The abiding' is the essential nature of self-knowing mind. Therefore 'confusion' is delusion. 'The lowest of persons' refers to those with awareness and so forth. 'Unable to realize' means: not knowing, because of being accompanied by confusion."

The question was then put: "Blessed One, if that is not sought, how can the suchness of those beings be sought?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mind, mental factors, and the nature of mind — self." This phrase means: the essential nature of the mind of sentient beings. "Mind" here means: the living principle that has the character of cognizing, in all things, the nature of phenomena such as virtuous aggregates and the like — it is the entity possessed of that character. "Having the nature of gnosis as its self" means: that which pervades everywhere; in that, the person is the self whose nature is the gnosis of Viṣṇu that pervades all things. "Having the nature of what is to be known" means: seed, born of seed, the one who feels, the one who acts, the object understood as place, that which has its own intrinsic form, and agenthood itself. Those who speak of a Lord of Power (Īśvara) say that the Lord of Power is the agent in all phenomena. "The very existence of the qualified subject as its essential nature" means: from the extreme of establishing that very self-possessing entity, the Great God (Śiva) is posited as the agent of phenomena such as merit and the like, or as the essential nature of phenomena — a Great Lord of Power, a Lord of Power.

In order to demonstrate that fully, the Blessed One taught: the consequence and the repudiation, the singular and the many, what is to be proved, the subjects of proof, the reasons, and the examples. Among these, the statement "of phenomena" and so forth — and "by many": if one were to argue for multiplicity as the cause of what is to be proved, this would not produce multiplicity itself. Since this is stated in order to prove singularity, the example of the river and the ocean is given for both. This is to be cited as an example because it is proved by both the singular and the many. As to this: first, the things such as mind, stated at the end of the Dharma of multiplicity — the many phenomena — are indeed numerous, since they turn away from the one in a sequence of various forms. "By many, phenomena" means: non-Buddhists, by way of cause, posit mind and so forth in many different forms. "Blessed One, is this the object of thought?"

The Blessed One declared: "The phrase 'stream of a river' refers to the śrāvakas. 'Ocean' means: just as outside the inner sea, the streams of rivers — the Sītā, the Sindhū, the Gaṅgā, and the like — flow and circulate, and one does not come to see them as multiple — thinking 'this is the river Sindhū, this is the river Gaṅgā' — so too, outside the profound and unfathomable dharmadhātu, non-Buddhists posit as multiple what they call self, the living principle, person, and individual. Blessed One, is the suchness here of a multiple character?" The Blessed One declared: "It is not. Whoever posits suchness here as singular is apprehending the nature of that suchness as being one alone."

As for the phrase "singular and multiple" and what follows — the term "multiple" refers to those manifold forms of mind and so forth, which are not apprehended by the noble ones and are not understood by reasoning. Because multiplicity enters into unity — just as the multiplicity of rivers enters into the ocean — it is not understood by reasoning that mind, self, and so forth exist. And even when brought into accord with reasoning, when mind and so forth have entered into the selflessness of all phenomena, their multiplicity is still not accepted. Just as, when the multiplicity of rivers has entered into the ocean, there is no separately appearing thing there — so too, because there is no thing that is multiplicity, suchness is understood as being of the character of unity. By such a character as this, from where is suchness to be found?

The Blessed One declared: "What is called 'from the mouth of the master' — the master is one who possesses mantra, tantra, and oral instruction, and it is through words that the oral instruction is to be found." The Blessed One then declared the definitive oral instruction of that master:

"What is called 'inner' refers to dwelling in such a form at the crown of the beautifully veined channels, adorned with the five spaces. The secret lotus is said to mean the secret place. It is the place of the crown's space, beautified by the five channels at the navel of the lotus that hold blood, semen, and urine in the direction of the crown of beautifully veined channels. Or alternatively, it is adorned with these five spaces — water, fire, the great sovereign wind, cool, hot, and the character of heat from both — by entering into the maṇḍala of attachment. It is not adorned by the lotus alone." So the Blessed One declared.

"What is called 'secret' has seven aspects of meaning; the eighth is the characteristic of being inexpressible. 'Secret' means 'not manifest.' There, that very secrecy is the direction — it is a brief indication of suchness. Secret is the

five seeds. Secret is the hidden noble substance. Secret is the secret lotus. Secret is the joy of the navel. Secret is that which goes everywhere. Secret is all bliss without limit — thus explained by the texts of the tantra."

As for "secret," the tantra text states:

The first secret is the awakening mind.
The second is skillful means and wisdom.
The third is compassion itself.
The fourth is the noble essence.
The fifth is said to be equality.
The sixth is loving-kindness itself.
The seventh is the wisdom of the nature of reality.
All of these dwell everywhere as their abode.

The awakening mind is unborn,
the supreme meditative absorption of manifold forms.
By name it is described in general as "the beautiful."
That beloved of Vajrasattva,
sole dweller in the abode of the many,
is the Perfection of Wisdom —
omniscient, all-pervading, wholly complete,
a subtle-essence secret sky-traveler,
and because it knows a hundred illusory forms,
all buddhas expound it.

By means of objects such as a mirror and the rest,
the five mantras are correctly explained,
and it is said to be the Perfection of Wisdom.

The first syllable becoming one —
mirror and the rest: the five Sugatas.

The sixth is glorious great bliss.

And that one's other wisdom —
above the sixth, it has no renown.

In the tantra of a hundred thousand sections
the sixth is not said to exist.

One like Vajrasattva
does not exist in the human world.
Therefore I explain this to you.
One who enters inward into this very thing —

whoever abides in non-dual equality —
both formerly and hereafter the Blessed One,
the glorious Vajrasattva, has declared this.

At this point the master asked: "What is the wisdom that goes to all places?"

The self of all abides constantly.
Its abode is taught in four aspects.
The four are endowed with parts and wholeness.
It abides in the four lotuses:
at the crown — it abides in the heart-lotus;
at the mouth — it abides at the crown of the mouth-lotus;
at the navel-lotus abides the sound;
and at the end of that sound, at the secret lotus,
it causes coming and going.
It is perfectly encircled by the union of the drop.
Its colors are black, red,
white, and likewise yellow.
The part is the form of the Blessed One's drop.
The part is called the part of wisdom.
The sound of the goddess is precisely taught.
That one is the great magical Knowledge-Woman,
of boundless variegated form,
who brings forth — sorrow, fear, and longing —
the sound of the drop fully encircling.

Through the ritual of the eighty-four thousand
heaps of phenomena,
not knowing the suchness of the body,
all of these are without fruit.

The first among the syllables is A.
It abides in all that is stable and moving.
Great compassion has arisen with longing.
The mouth opens space below.
The god who has no beginning and no end —
its crown is precisely revealed.
This supreme suchness —
I, the goddess, have fully revealed.

From this very thing all arises.
The dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, is uttered as BHRŪṂ.
It abides perfectly in the center of the birthplace.
Because of the SVĀHĀ at the end,
it is expressed as "condensed."

Bones, limbs, and semen —
the three born from the father are taught.
Skin, flesh, and blood —
these are proclaimed the three born from the mother.
Those that are expressed as merely these
are indeed the aggregated lumps condensed.
Form, feeling, perception,
formations, and consciousness itself —
these are directly grasped by the five buddhas.
They are to be proclaimed "the aggregates."
Form, sound, smell,
taste, and touch itself —
these are explained as "the dharma-element."
The elements and the sense bases —
from these there arises the lump from the semen;
from the lump, human beings come forth.
The mind pervades all the space-element.
The sense bases, the elements,
the sense faculties, the aggregates, the primary elements,
and what arises from the elements —
the maṇḍala is said to be the body.
The maṇḍala is expressed as the bhaga.
The maṇḍala also is the awakening mind.
The maṇḍala is to be contemplated in three ways.

In whom the primal one acts entirely,
ever becoming manifold throughout —
the aggregate is taught in two aspects.
The primary elements should always be analyzed.
The intoxicant, the hook,
the lasso, the lotus-inserter,
the chain-binding, the bell —

these are taught as the definitive ones.
Excrement is called "the white one."
Lotus is said to mean blood.
What is called "flesh" is the butter-lamp.
Semen is expressed as space.
Because of absorption, it is called the dancing-ground.
"Flower" is expressed as the bhaga of the heart.
Song is the song of the upswelling.
Dance is the union of equanimity.
Taste is expressed as the deceased.
"Mouth" means face and aperture.
The essence-taste is burned at the charnel ground.
Fire is bright, consuming the offering,
and likewise blazing.
"Sugar" is expressed as bdellium.
The sun of the black spirit-beings
is the fourteenth day of the waning fortnight.
"Gold-tree" is dharu-ra.
Alaṃka is long pepper.
Madulungā is full of seeds.
Citraka is citraka.
Baca is the word itself.
The house-bird's egg, in all cases, is a piece of a house-bird's egg.
"Gray-white" is white.
"Horse-slayer" is karavīra.
"The sun-tree" is the arka tree.
"Broken into pieces" means the meaning of "broken" and "burned by fire."
"Sin" is snake.
"Alaṃ" is tail.
"Kalāpa" is a part.
"Anointing with midday milk" means thoroughly smeared.
Vānarī is kapī.
"Region" is expressed as kacchara.
Its own nature is skull-circlet, monkey, and —
Khaṭika is to be kept in midday milk for seven days. Mixed together with that
midday milk, it is to be used to anoint the sense organ of the head. "It will

administer poison" means it produces an effect through contact. "What comes from Malaya" is sandalwood. Nāga-kesara is nāga. "The chief of diseases" is ruta. "The fruit of the intoxicating plant" is the fruit of a thorny shrub. "The domain of the jagu" is to be understood as the proliferation of the intoxicating plant. Takara is the fragrant takara. "Endowed" means combined. "Rice-water" is kosha. "The many kinds of all-manner poison" is of numerous forms. "It destroys" means it causes exhaustion. "Born in its daytime" means what has died in its daytime. "Child" is a young boy. Roca is excrement. Tagara is the nāga-shrub. "The place of the essence" means what has been inserted. "Frog" is what has essence. "The two-headed manifestation" is a two-headed serpent. "Boiling blood and fat" is expressed as oil. "The barura tree" is its fruit. "Hand" is the right hand. "Poison destroys what it has seized" means it snatches away what it has seized. "Cow's butter" is ghee from a cow. "The vajra-possessing one" is the milk of snuhi. Bṛhī is peacock. "Blood" is born from a wound. "The flesh of the two-headed serpent" is flesh. "A seventh part of the root of balaka" means a seventh portion. Oṃ Vajra Kara Hūṃ Phaṭ. "The sound that subdues spirits, making an end of spirits" is renowned as being of spirits itself. If bound to the right hand, it liberates from demonic possession; otherwise, it does not. "The lord of serpents" is the king of snakes. "Bark" is what has been peeled. "The enemy of the serpent" is the peacock, specifically its wing. "Two crows" is crow. "What fears the day" is the owl. "Horse" is swift-moving. "Hoof" is foot. "Hole" is a hollow. "Placing" means inserting. "Snake" is serpent. "Yakṣa" is dog. "Skull" causes disgust. "Pig" is pig. "Head-born" is hair. "Long-necked" is a drum. "Red" is blood. Bhallātaka itself, and stara, is emblic itself. "Hand-born" is fingernail. "The fire of the kiss" is the heat of the junction of the lips. "Burned" means reduced to ash. Aṃkoṭa is the aṃkoṭa tree. "Sweet-smelling" is cow. An eye-salve made from oil extracted from gathered seeds of aṃkoṭa, mixed with milk — one anoints the eye with that eye-salve. "Winning" is the star Winning. With the sediment of aṃkoṭa oil, the fruit of takara, the oil of aṃkoṭa seeds, and the sediment of both combined — if one anoints the eyes, one takes on the form of a god. If anointed with the eye-salve of the fruit of takara, one returns to one's former nature and sees oneself as one truly is. "The water of the moon-marked one" is the apple. Jāluka is the lotus itself. "Frog-butter" is the butter of the essenced one, together with the root of batala. "A renunciant" is one who has cut the hair. "What comes from the moon" is what comes from the apple. Dundubha is the two-faced snake. "Blood" is what holds form. Having inserted it inside a garment, place it in the mouth. It is the tree called Syenāka. Marsara is white butter. "A red spike" is a

golden spike. "What is called bad-smelling" is medicine. Mīna is fish. "Worm" is the insect that moves through wood. Kokila is the bee. "Molasses" is guḍa itself. Araṇala is sour gruel. "The twice-born" is a brahmin. "Cat" is one who hides the thick ones. "Monkey" is vānara. "Self-heating" is a menial servant. "The enemy of the crow" is the owl.

Nagula is the mongoose. Caramā is the cat. These are their powders. Bāglatshe is the jackal. Mātulunka is what is full of seeds. Phukhron is the pigeon. "One with a copper topknot" is a domestic bird. The thick matter of these is to be gathered. "What is called the extremity of hair-work" is a head massage. Picumarda is neem. Gtor-zan is the crow. "The white one accompanied by joy" is the white female dog. Nūpa is what is adhesive. "An arrow-wound" is a small insect. Snūnpa is what has been beaten. "One's own seed" is one's own substance. Rgyal is the lunar mansion Rgyal. Skyesma is a woman. "Taking a bad portion" is what has been taken up. "The tree of the born" is the mango and so forth. "A tree branch" is a leaf. Pilu is an elephant. "Drawing upward" is holding with the hand. "What intoxicates a man" is a substance. Krānta is what overpowers Viṣṇu. Sravanti is weeping. Avanatajāḥikā is joining the palms in reverence. Śikhā is the crest of a peacock. "The lord of sky-farers" is the lord of the garuḍas. "The hidden lord of gods" is the hidden Indra. Bāblā is manśilā. Drongros is green drongros. Agrā is watercress. "Born from cutting" is dūrvā grass. Bkra-shis is rocana. Bhaṃsa is the navel that has become prominent. "The barley of the senses" is the seed of kuṭaja — according to some it is the seed of kuṭaja. "All splendor" is endowed with beauty. Aruṇā is red sandalwood. "The son of a sage" is one who moves through the sky and one who is sky-born. "The heart of a mountain" is what cannot be overcome by others. Srod is an eye-ointment for the ear. "A thorn marked by the hare" is the thorn of the śephalī plant. "Honey" is that of bees. "Honey" is the honey of yaṣṭi. "The first flower" is the blood of the first lunar mark. "What is called the three irons" is gold, silver, and copper. "The aśoka tree, indicated and combined by the two blues," is the blue aśoka. The sprout arising from that is the sprout arising from the blue aśoka. "The sun" is copper, very red. "The moon" is silver. "Fire" is gold. "The musk of an ox" is the musk of an ox. "The flower of the ingudī tree" is the kuṣuṃsa of the ingudī tree — the total gathering of all flowers of that tree. "The obstructing one" is a dead man — his eyes and hairs. "What is accompanied by the eating of the second Ka" is what has been vomited after being eaten by a crow, together with what remains uneaten. "The father's pleasure garden" is

the charnel ground. "Being pleased there" is taking the substance of a girl intoxicated by the lunar mark. "What is both aśoka and blue" is the blue aśoka. The crow's nest on its northern side is the dwelling of crows. The sprout that arises from that is the sprout from the crow's nest on the northern side of the blue aśoka. One places the srotāñjana into the hollow of a pigeon and then burns it with the fire of citā wood — from that an eye-ointment is accomplished. "Killed by what is not a white cat" is: having rendered invisible with the blood of a black cat, it produces concealment. Those groups of sprouts of triṇa that have become prominent are the groups of prominent sprouts of triṇa. The earth raised by them is the earth raised by those groups of prominent sprouts of triṇa. The earth resting upon it is possessed of arrow-insects, and of tāla. "Arrow-wound" is the small insect. Tāla is drongros. Being fully possessed of these means: being composed of them — possessed of saragha and tāla. "To Rgyal" means to the sun of Rgyal. "Eye-ointment" is as stated above. If one who has been prepared by a combination of mantra and medicine is made excellent, the accomplishment will be achieved through that combination.

These come from the Yoga Tantra. Then it is said: "The accomplishment is to be performed in the center of the bhaga." First, having blessed it with a mudrā, one should insert the eye-ointment accomplishment into the bhaga from outside, and through the application one should meditate until the signs of accomplishment have arisen. It is said: "This eye-ointment alone, even without the mantra accomplishment, will also perform the pacifying activity and so forth." When the eye is anointed with the eye-ointment and one looks with a pacifying gaze and so forth, it becomes pacifying and so forth. When the eye is anointed with the eye-ointment and one looks at a king, one will obtain the king's offerings. When the eye is anointed with the eye-ointment and one looks at an enemy with a wrathful gaze, the enemy will be destroyed. Likewise, when one looks with certainty at all obstructing spirits, all obstructors such as possession spirits and the like will be utterly expelled. It is said: "One should openly praise and recite the mantra that is to be explained."

Having placed saffron in a woman's bhaga, one should then insert one's own accomplishment substance into it from outside, and through union one should recite the mantra and thereby accomplish it in a special way. The mantra for this, as declared, is: Oṃ prasannatāre amṛtamukhaṃ amṛtalocane sarvārthasādhani sarvasattvavaśaṃkara hūṃ phaṭ hūṃ svāhā. Oṃ trimukheṣaḍḍhuje devimālakiraudi rūpiṇi hrīṃ hrīṃ hūṃ hūṃ aṃ aṃ ha ha

svāhā. Having first recited the approach practice one hundred thousand times, it is said that one should then accomplish the eye-ointment and saffron again from outside. It is said that with that saffron one should make a dot on the forehead.

The declaration on making a woman fortunate: On top of the bhaga anointed with sandalwood paste, one should write the syllable "hūṃ" with ox bile and engage in union with the lord for as long as the intoxicating substance has not yet come. Thereafter that lord will become like a servant.

The term nṛpa means the king of bees. Citri means the thousand-petaled. Midnight means long pepper. Vakuci means apakuca. The essence of the utpala means the utpala before it has opened. The rust of iron means the excretion of iron. Fragrance and so forth means guggul and sarjarasa. That which clears blood means the color of an action. The golden tree means the golden shrub. Ḍiḍhaparo means vālā. Sinhupara means nirguṇḍā. Śyāmā means priyaku. Keśari means nāgakesara. The vidyādhara means campaka. Nāga means punarnagā. The wheel-weaver means eḍaci. The midnight practitioner means long pepper. Śikhi means the peacock's crest. Pravana means ballaka. The enemy of spirits means nirgunti. Varahṛda is said to refer to ballabhi and the thief's flower. Karaṇḍa means karaṇja. Mañjarī means that which subdues. The bark of the golden tree means its skin. Ghana means mustaka. The midnight tree means the black plum tree. The lord of disease means kunda. The dust of existence means the household flower. Thief means that which makes the old young. Keṃsu means its fully ripened fruit.

For one endowed with the accomplishment of the maṇḍala and so forth, in order to cut down some of those who arise, such as the māras who are sons of gods, the text states:

The great mudrā of all weapons —
the mechanical device thrown and not thrown,
and likewise that which is thrown by the hand,
the hurled together with the one who grasps what is hurled,
and the fifth, the combat of hands:
through the self-arisen Vedic knowledge of the bow,
the mudrā is to be firmly established.
In that context, thrown and applied means arrows and so forth;
not thrown means swords and the like;
released by the hand means the wheel and so forth;

going with grasping means the lasso and so forth.
Having fully relinquished all weapons,
through the combat of hands one subdues enemies and so forth.
Likewise, one is fully possessed of binding.

The glorious Vajrasattva (Skt. vajrasattva) shall clearly explain the superior
and various weapons — their places and their shapes — the yoga of practice,
supremely beautiful.

Engagement, swift application,
hooking, and grasping itself,
sending forth into clarity:
sealed by the mudrā of the posture with feet level on the ground.
The Vaiśākhā posture is to be sealed with the mudrā.
That very maṇḍala is to be sealed with the mudrā.
At the three places, with the right extended:
thus was the mudrā of the shape declared.
The thumbs and the fingers
are to be joined within a hollow tube.
Whatever is firmly joined
is said to be the place of the even-footed posture.
With the toes of the feet set outward,
both knees are raised and moved.
Twenty-six finger-widths measured off —
the place is called Vaiśākhā.
Both knees joined evenly
in the shape of a swan's wing,
with a span of two cubits between them:
that is said to be the maṇḍala posture.
Whatever, in the shape of a plowshare equally,
with the right knee guarding the thigh —
the left moves as an animal goes,
embraced, resting at thigh and hip —
fully extended five spans:
that is rightly celebrated as the right-extended posture.
The very reverse of that
is said to be the left-extended posture.
Neither slack nor rigid,

supple yet with steady limbs:
through which the sense bases are perfectly purified,
the mudrā of one's own body is beautiful.
Disease of epidemic, disease of poison,
harm from dākinīs, and all demonic afflictions —
by this, with all limbs adorned,
everything is overwhelmed completely.
This is the mudrā of the full sense bases.

With the yoga of drawing one's own heart,
grasping the bow itself with supreme beauty,
rotating it well to the right,
and placing the arrow — accomplishment is achieved.
First, with hands made even,
drawing back behind in proper order,
gently hooking,
all beings are to be hooked.
This is the mudrā of hooking all.

Having placed it within the maṇḍala of the ear's sense base,
just as the sequence requires,
for as long as Oṃ remains in one's own mouth,
for that long it is held at the ear.
When Oṃ in due time is repeated,
for that duration it is to be held.
This is the mudrā of holding.

Drawing evenly in the proper sequence,
it is to be held according to the rite.
One should draw it slightly,
and when it is fully filled, accomplishment is achieved.
This is the mudrā of filling.

Smiling and regarding with the eye,
the fist is to be applied to the target.
With the gaze placed in the fist,
released fully, supreme accomplishment is gained.
This is the mudrā of victory by the bow.

Quadrangular, sharp, and round,
and likewise supremely spinning —
it is to be spun from the right,
and likewise goes below and above.
Pressing in sequence, and pressing firmly,
with the supreme mudrā of the tenfold rite,
one enjoys the great kingship of the three realms
and the bliss of the Victors.

The glorious conqueror of the three worlds —
inserting the mudrā, placing evenly,
and likewise inserting it as if lightning —
with the absorption of the drawn mudrā,
and likewise spinning it as lightning,
below it moves evenly,
and likewise goes upward.

The Tathāgata-holding mudrā
is to be meditated upon at the three pure places.
This is the mudrā of all ornaments.

Everywhere, from every side, in every way,
at all times and in every aspect —
holding the mudrā of the bow's Vedic knowledge in one's own form,
the supreme syllable will be accomplished.
This is the mudrā of all weapons.

The one called Buddha-Vajra is Vairocana. Having become the form of the eye,
and by means of yoga that is united with Vairocana, one summons forth the
eye from the syllables of the mantra. With the full moon, with the hand of the
vessel, and with the desired wish of the mother goddess, when one
contemplates bestowing empowerment, the peaceful arises. Life is given to
the dead, and to those who desire attainment, spiritual accomplishment is
granted.

The passage beginning "vajra" and so forth, concerning arousing the samaya
(Skt. samaya) of the vajra — that is the arousal of the vajra's samaya. The
supreme samaya of the blazing three bodies of the mind-vajra is the defining
characteristic of Māmakī. Wherever there is meditative absorption, it is to be
recited just as it stands. Having drawn forth the white syllables of the mantra
of the vajra family, one then contemplates filling the body of the object of
accomplishment with them; this destroys evil and negativity. For peaceful

rites, one acts as though the mother goddess has opened her eyes. For expanding rites, one contemplates drawing down a rain of jewels from a jewel-vessel. For great passion, it is that which has been opened by the dance of the one by whom the lotus of Amitābha is pressed — thus the all-accomplishing one who has become in that way is possessed of the essential nature of all families. The all-accomplishing of any one of them is the accomplishing of all. By the visualization of what has been accomplished thereby, the vajra is to be visualized in meditative absorption, and it is recited just so. The vajra is Vairocana. The lotus is Amitābha. Having drawn forth the mantra syllables like the color of gold and conferred empowerment upon the practitioner, great expansion is produced. If one meditates on the emanating and gathering of these, the treasury of Dharma increases. Abiding inwardly at the heart of the lotus at one's own heart center, blessed by the garland of syllables of the mantra to be accomplished, and having placed the manifold vajra (viśvavajra) on the crown of the head, if one then enters into meditative equipoise in proper sequence, great protection is established. Because everything comes under mastery, there is freedom from conceptuality; and that which realizes and generates mastery and the other qualities of that kind is Amogha-Vajra — the meaningful vajra. That very one delights through the equality of the three vajras. The vajra is indivisible. By entering into meditative equipoise in that absorption, one draws forth red mantra syllables. By that, one purifies the objects of accomplishment, and when recitation is performed, one effects the dispatching of an emissary. She who liberates all through wisdom is Tārā — she who is the mother that causes wisdom to enter. At that time, for the sake of visualization, it is taught just so. Manifold wisdoms are the diverse supramundane wisdoms. The wrathful ones — such as Vajra-Yamāntaka and others — exist for the purpose of taming the malicious, by means of those very wisdoms. They are the very canopy itself. Beautiful means not deficient in major or minor marks. Without a stub means it is a single piece. With a second stub means it is of two pieces — and these accord with the relevant contexts. The rite called "the dust from the footprint" is what is being described here: the yogin of Yamāntaka, endowed with the yoga of the four goddesses, blessed by the five Tathāgatas — one makes an image of the object of accomplishment from the dust of that one's footprint and places it inside a skull-cup. Having placed and bound it there, one presses it with the left foot, and while pressing, recites with repeated arousal for as long as one has penetrated. By meditating on the three bodies indivisibly — as stated by the phrase "meditating on the three bodies as indivisible" — one stabilizes the

divine pride of oneself as the deity. The supreme of great delusion is Amogha-Vajra, the meaningful vajra, and its wisdom is the awakening mind arisen from the vajra tip. Therefore, the wrathful Vajrāmṛta — in whatever meditative absorption — is to be recited just so. The phrase "placed at the feet of the lord of the assembly" means: endowed with the yoga of the amṛta combined with skillful means (thāb-sbyor), one makes an image of the object of accomplishment from the dust of that one's footprint using the urine of a donkey, seals it with a non-virtuous mudrā, and threads a śālu plant through the petals of a wind-maṇḍala —

one writes the name of the object of accomplishment visibly into the interior of a skull, places five images at the back, summons the vajra-inverter, makes offering, and then inserts it at that one's feet. The phrase "one does that" means: for as long as that lasts, one recites the syllable Hūṃ at the end of the mantra. When the wind has become an obstruction, at that time one visualises emptiness according to the sequence explained above and is declared to arouse oneself in the form of the glorious Vairocana. In the direction of the wind, using black ink, one draws a square maṇḍala with seven bindus placed within individual YA syllables; in the centre of that are the seven bindus. From these seven bindus seven wind-gods arise, mounted on deer, their colour black. "Arisen from one's own seed" means: one draws them forth from one's own heart-centre. One should visualise the noble Acala — the Immovable Lord — being summoned by the King of Desire and bound with a noose. Then, as for the phrase "with a bowl," from Hūṃ Sūṃ Hūṃ one generates the form of Mount Meru with eight horns, turns it mouth-downward and sets it in place — this is the great vajra-binding. "Reciting the mantra oneself" means: one conceals the seven bindus with the mantra and lets them rest by the breath. Above that, from LAṂ, a square maṇḍala of the Great Lord, yellow in colour. From the great five-pointed vajra there, one causes wrathful ones of terrifying aspect to stream forth as boundless rays of light, and one meditates on the wrathful ones being pressed down by the vajra. Above that, placing the left foot down, one recites the mantra of the noble Acala, the Immovable Lord, one hundred and eight times. On the vajra, one visualises the Blessed One Vairocana and the noble Acala with right foot extended, subduing everything, while before the Blessed One a sword is held in hand and a noose restrains the wind. By this, even all the winds of the time of destruction will be bound. As for "the great mighty one" and so forth, for the purpose of bringing down rain: one draws a lotus with eight petals, and on the eight petals one places Ananta,

Kulika, Vāsukī's son, Śaṅkhapāla, Takṣaka, Mahāpadma, Kāraṇa, and Padma — these, according to the sequence of their identities, are yellow and white. By the mantras ŚA ŚA SA HA SĀṂ SVĀṂ SVĀ, one consecrates the eight nāgas with their own seeds, abiding in the eight heart-syllables; one summons the former ones and makes offering. Here, the lord of the assembly whose nature is the blazing host of wrathful forms, by reciting with great excellence Hūṃ NAM Hūṃ, one meditates on the nāgas being skewered beneath the feet — and in that way the finest rain will be caused to fall in abundance. The Blessed One then declared the purpose of stopping rain. Visualising oneself in the form of a wrathful deity, intensely red like the radiance of the sun's colour, with a blazing Hūṃ upon one's tongue, as vast as the sky, splitting and completely filling space — by this, one inhales the clouds through the hollow of the heart and, exhaling, scatters them like tufts of cotton. Alternatively, by releasing the blazing host of one's own mudrā, splitting and cutting, one supremely suppresses them with Hūṃ. The Blessed One then declared the purpose of destroying that. As for "the maṇḍala of fire" and so forth: one who is endowed with perpetual yoga draws forth from one's own forehead the noble Acala, the Immovable Lord, arisen from RAṂ, abiding in the maṇḍala of fire, six-armed — from the left KṢIṂ, the pointing finger of threat; from HŪṂ, placed within a noose; from DHAM, a bow. From the right, from KHAM, a sword; from HO, an arrow; and one visualises holding a vajra from HŪṂ.

By the rays of light from that very deity, together with the wrathful ones, all obstructers are made to resound with the cry of Hūṃ, and they are pierced with blazing swords and the like, struck down by arrows that have been shot — thus are the obstructers born of men destroyed.

As for "the great blood of men" and so forth: one makes an image to be accomplished using the dust of footprints and the blood of men, then with twenty mantras endowed with light-rays one gloriously consecrates the stake-pegs made of human bone, drives a stake-peg into the eye, and inserts it into the mouth of the lord of the assembly.

For the syllable Oṃ Sumbha, vajra pestle and hammer — one should visualize first striking the face with the hammer, then striking the back with the pestle.

For the purpose of destroying the blazing one, "the colour of eye-medicine" and so forth: into the space of the sky one inserts Hūṃ Gaḥ Hūṃ inwardly.

From the syllable Phuḥ there arises a black nāga; one commands the garuḍa dwelling in the sky, encircled by a thousand black nāgas. Having meditated

exactly as it is, "Om Vajranārāyaṇa" and so forth: first one summons, and by that summons one also stirs Śakra (Indra) with the mind. This too — one commands the rain-cloud for the purpose of rain; and even if the command is heard and rain falls, if one wishes in mind to turn back the cloud, the garuḍa turns it back with its wings and, by piercing it with its beak, makes a boundary for the river. The meaning of the vajra-turning-back is hereby declared.

As for "fire offering" and so forth: for the purpose of performing virtuous acts, for the characteristics of pacification, enrichment, and subjugation, one uses fire produced by the fire-drill. For wrathful activity, one uses the fire of the charnel ground.

The fire-pit is round, square, half-moon shaped, or triangular. Along the rim of the fire-pit, accordingly, one should also place lotuses in white, yellow, red, and black. Then, in accordance with the corresponding colour, the uṣṇīṣa, the water-born lotus, the precious jewel, and the blazing vajra are to be made — that is the meaning.

"Recitation accomplishes all activities" — this means that they are eminently consecrated by Hūṃ.

"With the left-hand vajra" means that the left hand is formed into the three-pronged vajra.

"Adorned with the light of activity" means ornamented with light in the manner appropriate to the activity — pacification and so forth.

"Having caused it to be fully absorbed in the blazing form" — here "blazing" means either a deity or a blazing scorching form. In the same way, one meditates on the ritual procedure of the nature of primordial wisdom. From Om at the beginning and Svāhā at the end, abiding supreme, one applies it to pacification, enrichment, and subjugation. For wrathful activity, one recites the mantra with wrathful words combined with Hūṃ and Phaṭ. At the beginning and the end one offers oblation in full measure. The phrase "filling the mouth" means one performs the fire offering at the lotus of the deity's mouth.

As for the oblation materials such as excrement, urine, and so forth, one should have no apprehension of sin or the like, because ultimately all things are pure by nature — everything is mere conceptual imputation.

Then also, entering into the union of the two faculties, one places the divine pride foremost, makes the union of skillful means and wisdom manifest, and generates undefiled primordial wisdom.

The Blessed One declared that the body and so forth are to be correctly explained. As for "the body of a woman and of a man, produced by many actions" and so forth — what is called "explaining fully" refers to the person who knows the characteristics of virtuous and non-virtuous karma. Flesh, limbs, and so forth are of the nature of Vairocana, Akṣobhya, and so on — for this reason they are to be employed.

As for "whatever attachment, aversion" and so forth:

The increase of formations — excretion, urination, and the five remaining outflows — constitutes the perfection of the intrinsic nature of the four elements: earth and so forth.

"From meditation" means through intelligence that is free from conceptual elaboration.

"Then the supreme is to be fully explained. From all things, the supreme of diverse kinds" — this refers to whatever is perfectly endowed with a square shape, four gateways, and guardians of the gateways.

"The maṇḍala of the assembly is to be examined" — this, it is taught, refers to the outer maṇḍala. The inner maṇḍala is then to be shown.

"The diverse mudrā from all things" and so forth — this refers to being endowed with the goddesses such as the glorious Buddha-Lochanā and the rest.

"The one endowed with the diverse wheel from all things" — the glorious Vajrasattva is placed in the position declared above, and after that, the four boundary regions are consecrated with the mantras and mudrās of Caṇḍā and the rest. A khadira-wood stake of eight finger-widths is taken; reciting its mantra and striking with a vajra-hammer, one drives stakes progressively into the navel and into the boundary regions of Caṇḍā and the rest — stakes named Anantā, Vijayā, and so forth — and the maṇḍala attendant is established in place.

With fragrant substances and so forth, reciting first one's own hūṃ and the first syllable of its name in the abode of all the gods of the maṇḍala ground, one scatters it. Then, drawing out beforehand the wheel of the assembly maṇḍala as the wheel of one's own deity, one invites the deity to remain in its proper place. First, the consecration through invitation and so forth as taught is to be performed. Together with one's own mantra and mudrā, one gazes closely and bestows empowerment, makes offering, recites praise, and

performs prostration. Then, in order to pacify the afflicted mind, one performs a fire offering and scatters tormas offerings in the directions.

Just as one has now established superior residence at the root vase and so forth, so too the disciple-attendant is to be established in place. Having first scattered water recited with hūṃ upon the heart center, one then places the hand holding the vajra upon it, and visualizes a five-pronged vajra at the heart and a diverse vajra upon the crown of the head throughout.

Taking refuge in the Three and so forth is performed, and tying a cord blessed with hūṃ around the shoulders, one gives a tooth-stick and fragrant substances and so forth.

To them the Dharma is taught and they are introduced to the maṇḍala ground; through the rays of light emanating from it, one invites the deity to approach.

"As before, through complete transformation" — this refers to performing offerings and so forth. Just as the wheel of the deity has been drawn out in the manner described, so too that very wheel of the deity is to be visualized inwardly in the same way — this is the full extent of the meaning.

Furthermore, first, endowed with the yoga of conceptual construction, one draws out Akṣobhya and the rest from the heart center and makes them identical in nature with the five cords of blue and the remaining colors. Turning gently with hūṃ, one recites that hūṃ one hundred and eight times.

In this way it is taught that the colored powder too is to be drawn in accordance with this very yoga. Consecrated by the five buddhas, and drawing the lines in the proper directions of the maṇḍala, first the master draws the colored powder design, and afterward the disciples draw the five kinds of colored powder — blue, red, white, green, and yellow — on the outside of the maṇḍala. For the second section: blue, red, and white — three colors. For the third section, the wheel is of white colored powder. "The wheel's hub blazing with diversity" — great Vairocana is to be placed there, residing on a diverse lotus.

In the eastern and other cells of the wheel are placed the goddess of permanence and so forth — these represent the directions. At the eastern and other junctions of the wheel are Locana and the other goddesses. In the eastern and other directions of the second section are the wrathful vajra goddesses and their companions. In the eastern and other corners of the stripes of the third section, the bodhisattva Maitreya and the other

bodhisattvas are to be drawn. At the eastern gate are placed the Vajra Hook goddess and the others. At the junctions are Murja and the others. The maṇḍala is to be drawn in this manner.

Now, once the vase has been properly prepared, one hundred and eight recitations are to be performed. The root vase belongs to the lord of the maṇḍala. The fourth vase is assigned to the four goddesses beginning with Locana. Through the division of the lineages of all the gods there are four vases. Then the vase that stands at the gate — having been purified by means of all-action recitation as a fumigation offering — these vases, adorned with garments and the like, and the master, being endowed with the yoga of lordship, through excellent yoga meditates the wheel of all the gods within his own being and abides in the pride thereof.

Reciting throughout the service-use of the water offering, the gate is opened. The vases and the rest are placed in their proper positions, the deities of the maṇḍala are drawn forth as before, and the wheel is to be introduced into their proper abodes. In order that the mudrās of one's own deity may confer blessing, one displays one's own mudrā and, having visualized oneself abiding in the meditative absorption of self-empowerment through one's own authority, one makes offering with the earlier offerings such as the gesture of the alluring one and the rest, and, the vidyās who have been blessed by the distinctive offerings of one's own pleasing offerings — drums, flutes, and so forth — with palms joined, recite three times the well-composed vajra song, and prostrate. Then, the fire offering taught for the purpose of bringing satisfaction having been performed, one thereafter requests forgiveness.

For the purpose of all attainments (siddhi), having prayed oneself, one generates the first and subsequent ones, and adorns the disciples with various ornaments. With oṃ and the rest, one blesses the heart and the other places with the mudrā of blessing of the body and so forth. With palms joined and index fingers interlocked in the form of a wheel, reciting hūṃ, one performs this at all five places. Having covered the face with a cloth, one takes a flower held in the mudrā of the Vajra Goddess and the others, introduces it with hūṃ itself, and performs all the rites of the crown. Having been blessed through the yoga of glorious Vajrasattva, one adorns with incense, flowers, and the like, and in the proper manner, empowerment is conferred by means of all the vases.

The Tathāgatas offer the water offering, and one is to regard those holding vases filled with excellent nectar as conferring empowerment. Furthermore, adorned with garments and the like, having been empowered by the vajra and the rest, and the many forms of Akṣobhya and others having fully manifested, one performs the proximate rites of the skull bowl, the rosary, the vajra, the lord, and the vajra name empowerment; the veil of ignorance is cleared away with a stylus of gold and the like; and a mirror is taken up. Then the defining characteristics are to be proclaimed by means of the verse beginning "It is the very nature of glorious Vajrasattva" and so forth.

With the first vowel, the book is given; with the vowel following the first, the vajra bell; and for the purpose of granting permission to teach, the feet are blessed and a sword is given into the right hand. From this day forth, turn the wheel of Dharma for the world — this and what follows, beginning with "O Protector," is to be properly visualized.

The phrase "from this day forth" and what follows sets forth the pledges in close detail. The preceptor then accepts the fee and performs the pacifying fire offering. After performing the offerings, praises, and so forth, the syllable hūṃ is to be recited. With the words "O Vajrasattva of the awakening mind — muḥ," the deity's maṇḍala wheel is invited to depart. Then, drawing out the ritual dagger, and in the same way with the secret maṇḍala described above, the departure is invited using both hands as previously described. Reciting jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ, one meditates inwardly that the supremely exalted one abides in his own proper seat. By means of the syllable hūṃ alone, the colored sand is swept away, gathered up, and poured into water.

Since the wrathful one holds the quality of wrath, it is declared that glorious Heruka arises — and the passage beginning with the words "That very one is the Blessed One who is the yogin" and so forth is a proclamation made to the son of the family under the heading "The First Yoga of Glorious Vajrasattva." There it is stated that those who engage in the ten non-virtues such as taking life, and those whose pledges have degenerated, are purified — and the word "purified" here means cleansed. He possesses the flavor conveyed by the phrase "resplendent and alluring" and so forth.

The Blessed One declared: eight faces, four feet, and adorned with sixteen hands, with twenty-four eyes.

Furthermore, by this gradual sequence, the Blessed One is arrayed with four faces and four arms. Of these, the first face is wrathful. The second, on the

right, is radiant with bliss and awe-inspiring. The third face, at the back, partakes of wondrous food. On the left, the face is alluring and grants nectar. Likewise, the topmost face, called "the glaring one," is the supreme expression of all activity. The three faces convey the primordial wisdom of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness. The vajra-bearer of Akṣobhya's form similarly has six arms.

In the elaborated form, two arms with a single face are also to be depicted, and at the left shoulder, for the purpose of offerings, the ritual connection holds the vajra and bell in the pure joining gesture, along with the khaṭvāṅga staff. In his right hands are a three-pronged banner tip, the vajra hook, and a blazing wheel. In his left hand he holds a skull-cup filled with great compassion.

The phrase "seated in the half-cross-legged posture of the Great Seal" means seated upon a high throne — the left foot is placed upon the ground, and the right foot is raised onto the left thigh, in the joining posture of the awakening-mind's cross-legged seat. By pressing with the sole of that foot, the left thigh is brought into union through the joining posture.

O son of the family, one who practices the maṇḍala of the great seal in the cross-legged posture — the posture of the Blessed One seated upon the wrathful throne — will fully attain its accomplishment. By the joining of the raised foot upon the left thigh, bringing it to powder and extending it fully, the wrathful body is to be visualized above the face, and from that position the substance of accomplishment is to be drunk. That very one is to be meditated upon above the face of the Blessed One, and by means of the right foot in the joining posture of the vajra cross-legged seat, all women are taken as one wishes, and union is accomplished by moving the left thigh.

Alternatively, the face mudrās are to be proclaimed. In the eastern cell: a white, peaceful face. To the right: the fierce face of the robber woman. At the back: the utterly stupefied one — the face of her who is bewildered by the intoxication of bliss. To the left: the face of the risen corpse woman, rigid and erect. In the fire cell: Pukkaśī with the dancing face. In the cell of the non-true: the caṇḍāla woman, with a face full of reverence for all, through the union of stealing the life of another.

In the wind cell: Ghasmarī with the face of one who consumes the dead, engaged in union. In the cell of power: the form of the Blessed One in the likeness of Heruka. The white one has the gaze of peacefulness. The robber

woman has the fierce gaze. The utterly stupefied one has the gaze of utter stupefaction. The risen corpse woman has the gaze that rouses the dead. Pukkasī has the dancing gaze. The caṇḍāla woman gazes upward. Ghasmarī gazes downward upon the seat.

When one visualizes the white woman as present in a flower and gives that flower to someone, that person is sealed with the mudrā. In poison, the form is that of the robber woman. In ale, the form is that of the utterly stupefied one. In water, the form is that of the risen corpse woman. In a wooden staff, it is Pukkasī. In cloth, it is the fierce one. In fire, it is Ghasmarī — and through the meditative absorption of one-pointed union, she abides everywhere.

Thereafter, sealing with the mudrā is also to be performed through the meditative absorption of the white one, as it is stated. Acting in this way: through the meditative absorption that the robber woman draws forth from the old abode, she enters the body of the one to be accomplished and draws from the heart. Through the union of the utterly stupefied one, one bewildered by bliss imagines the one to be accomplished as stupefied — thus, by bestowing bliss exceedingly, she causes utter stupefaction. Through the meditative absorption of the risen corpse woman, by scattering nectar-water she rouses the dead. Through the yoga of Pukkasī, by striking with a skull she causes dancing. By the extremely upward breath in the meditative absorption, becoming one together with the caṇḍāla woman, she causes killing. Through that meditative absorption of Ghasmarī, one is to consume by eating what is placed upon the seat.

The white one, through her leftward gaze upon the one to be accomplished, performs the sealing with the mudrā. With the mind she enters into the heart of the one to be accomplished, and with the left hand she draws forth and hooks the lotus of his heart. The robber woman draws from the heart. The utterly stupefied one — whether mentally or directly, acting through bliss-induced stupefaction — causes utter stupefaction. The risen corpse woman — whether mentally or by physically embracing — rouses death. The yoga of Pukkasī that causes dancing: by becoming one together with the one to be accomplished in the mind, she herself dances. By becoming one together with the one to be accomplished in the mind, bewildered by bliss and employing the upward gaze, the yoga of the fierce one causes killing. Through the yoga of Ghasmarī, having placed the one to be accomplished in the mouth, one is to partake and consume. "To consume" means that all enemies are utterly and perpetually devoured — that is the meaning.

The one who performs the vajra Hūṃ obtains the name "Liberator of the Three Worlds," and he is the Vajrasattva who has thoroughly conquered the three worlds.

Then, "elsewhere" means: adhering to all other wrathful ones — such as the beautiful one, the one with the power of compassion, and so forth — as being of a single taste as wrathful ones.

The Blessed One was asked: "What are the characteristics of the form of the wrathful one, and for what purpose were they taught?" Those who assert a self in the body, in the life-force, in the person, and so forth — the one who puts an end to all such conceptual constructs is the Lord of the Dead. The one who conquers, through the wheel of their constructs, these three agents is the supreme lord of accomplishment over all conceptual constructs. The king of wrathful ones, called Vajrabhairava, is to be explained: because from Viṣṇu (the All-Pervader) and the Great Lord (Śiva) onward — all of them — Vajrabhairava reduces to ash.

As for "great attachment" (rāga): great attachment is the vajra of desire, and what possesses its essential nature is expressed as such. Furthermore, having become Vajrasattva and then becoming the vajra of one who possesses desire — just as in spring, a garland of sweetly fragrant flowers —

— adorned with the heart and so forth, and because of possessing a flower-bow and arrows, I am desire.

The arrow of the three bodies, called "the arrangement of the arrow": in the middle of the flat surface of the fletchings, the syllables YUM, KHAM, and OM, together with the other two, are to be arranged as a set of three, and these substances are to be visualized at the crown of the consort's head together with the arrow, and for the purpose of the dripping they are taught at the edge of the lotus. If desire is melted, it is like the melting of desire. The word "lotus" means the essence; through having come under the power of the EVAM, it drips. "This teaching, boundless and supreme, the supreme vow of all buddhas" — thus the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, declared the vajra of body, speech, and mind of all Tathāgatas.

Then the Blessed Ones, and the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "You have perfectly taught the arising. Now, please explain to us what is called 'the covered painted form of various kinds': this is to be spoken of with regard to the thrones. The yoga of entering

into them from above is the yoga of the aim of that, the yoga of entering into the painted form. Therefore it causes self-arising. What is called 'perfectly and excellently taught' means 'caused to arise.' What is called 'the vessel of the lotus' is to be understood as a human skull. Now, further, the shape of the consort's maṇḍala shall be explained to you: the palace of the Tathāgata is round. What is called 'Heruka's crescent-moon shape' means the shape of the maṇḍala of wind. The form of the lotus and the form of the jewel are to be understood. 'As one desires' means 'as one intends.' In this way, whatever the practitioner desires — placed in the center of the throne of the Tathāgata, vajra, lotus, jewel, and sword — that very thing is the reflection of the Tathāgata and the rest. On the outside, the reflection of the supreme horse is to be inserted; this is what is taught as the maṇḍala of the supreme horse. 'As it is obtained' means 'as it is found.' Whatever ritual implements of the maṇḍala have arisen for a given person, one is to draw with those very implements. 'At whatever time' means: for one who desires pacification, one is to draw that throne in the center of the Tathāgata's maṇḍala. For the aim of increase, in the jewel maṇḍala one is to draw at sunrise. For wrathful activities, at midday and midnight, in the vajra maṇḍala. For other activities, in the lotus maṇḍala, at dusk. 'As one pleases' means there is no fixed time for the commitment pledge and the empowerment.

By placing four lines in the directions of east, south, north, and west, there is an eightfold maṇḍala. What is called "the empowerment of complete fullness" is all the empowerments of the master. "All disciples, superior, middling, and inferior": for the inferior, the maṇḍala empowerment and the daytime dot; for the middling, by means of the fish-skin; and those who are superior — to them it is to be given in the nature of a single buddha alone. What is called "born from a single piece as the head-vajra": a single piece and the head-vajra are born from a single piece. With a single-piece skull one may also confer the empowerment in the nature of a single piece. "Born from the head" means the vessel of the lotus. "A single piece" is a single piece — one is to understand everything expressed as "unbroken and intact." The syllable KAM is the skull, because it sustains the aggregates. Thus it is taught:

The nature of all buddhas is accomplished.

I, the single lotus, am likewise so.

This is the vajra-jewel empowerment of the Blessed One Vairocana. The glorious Heruka is the vajra empowerment.

The empowerment of Amitābha is the jewel empowerment, and recitation is also to be performed there. The half of the precious jewel is the vajra empowerment. The body of all buddhas is to be understood as the jewel empowerment. This is also that of Hayagrīva. That which is immovable by reason of the intrinsic nature of cause and result is also to be understood as Vajrasattva.

What is to be accomplished by the effort of this skull-seat? The accomplishment of intrinsic nature itself, through going-forth from that nature — by the power of going forth from intrinsic nature, conceptual thought regarding apprehended and apprehender is without occasion, and by reason of that essential nature one becomes suchness itself through going forth. That is accomplished by its own intrinsic nature.

"From the intrinsic nature of form of the skull-garland crown ornament" means: it is taught thus from non-dual primordial wisdom. Just as fire is accomplished in the intrinsic nature of heat, so likewise through going forth from that very nature, because intrinsic nature is utterly purified, one performs the yoga of excellent intention for that very suchness, and united as a single entity together with the wisdom-being, through the yoga of having become thus, all the Tathāgatas are to be realized.

One writes HŪṂ with the mind on the moon within one's own heart, and recites it, meditating that one's very self is equal to space. The moon-maṇḍala of that suchness is itself the moon-maṇḍala. Upon that, one also meditates HŪṂ on a five-pointed vajra. Having caused all the Tathāgatas to enter there, and having generated them there as Vajrasattva, one invites them, requests them to be seated upon the lotus-seat, and the emanations such as the eye-goddess and the rest are likewise to be invited to take their seats — that is the meaning.

Thus for Vairocana and the rest as well, one should look to the practice of arising from the elements of one's own family. Through this higher practice, the arising of those ones is like the arising of the sun and moon. From the outer and inner self they become the five syllables, and therefore all the goddesses are generated from the two and are complete. This is the ritual from which all activities arise and expand.

"Some" means those who have not seen. Since it individually discerns one's own mind, it is the awakening mind. A being who has planted mind in awakening is a bodhisattva. Their conduct is the conduct of awakening, and since one who has rightly found the heroic mind follows after it, one goes

accordingly.

Accomplishing victory, producing honey, and accomplishing every purpose — the bodhisattva acts for the benefit of sentient beings in the manner of remaining in the form of three stamens, transforming variously as dust, darkness, and heartwood for the sake of sentient beings as well. That which is utterly pure is Samantabhadra. Therefore this conduct of awakening, as to "how one follows," is as before.

"Emerging clearly from the needle" means, for the sake of sentient beings, the thirty-two major marks of a great being and the eighty minor marks in their fullness. The motes of sunlight from that mass of merit are the thirty-two major marks of a great being. The particles of those are the eighty minor marks. What is it that has become clear? Clarity is the particular grasping of qualities and the like, and the offering of great awakening is surrounded entirely by their assembly.

The māra who deceives the bodhisattva in the form of māra is the māra of birth. Because it kills the mind of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, the māra is the vajra of desire. Possessing the conquest of the four māras and having become victorious over the māras, having become Śākyamuni in one account, he became perfectly and fully awakened. Because he has cut through grasping at phenomena and persons, liberation is utterly pure. And in order to cut through the persons who are worldly yogins —

— and to cut through the grasping at the Dharma as belonging to śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Having thus realized selflessness with respect to both phenomena and persons, and in order to know fully how everything has come to be, all liberation is utterly pure. For this purpose the Blessed One Vairocana turned the wheel of Dharma. The sixty-two views of self, attachment in all its forms, and their purification — because no self is perceived in suchness, there is no inherent existence. For this purpose the lord-king of Avalokiteśvara is Padmanartteśvara, the lord of the lotus dance. The supreme wheel of all the gods of Tuṣita at their culmination is the sacred wheel. The supreme of the many miraculous displays of supernatural power is the sacred wheel of the gods.

Furthermore, noble child, what is called "the assembly of all buddhas" — the word "assembly" means a gathering. What is called "Sukhāvatī" is the supreme Tuṣita. Noble child, it is like the world-realm of Sukhāvatī. For example, just as the world-realm of Sukhāvatī is adorned by the gathering of

all the Tathāgatas, so likewise the Blessed One Padmanartteśvara and the glorious Vairocana and so forth are surrounded by measureless Tathāgatas — this is like the world-realm of Sukhāvatī. For this purpose Padmanartteśvara is the arising of the liberator. Through the generosity that does not perceive gift, giver, or recipient, in order to abandon miserliness, what is ultimately pure — for this purpose miserly sentient beings are engaged in the practice of utterly perfect generosity by means of the wisdom that thoroughly purifies the three spheres. This is the meaning of what is said.

The great seal (mahāmudrā) like the sun is the seal of the sun. What is called "the essence of space" — because it generates the essence from the wisdom of equality with space, it is called just so, for what it is. The lord of all attainments who fulfills all wishes: those who pray to become wheel-turners and the like for all sentient beings in all their forms — because it thoroughly grants those wishes, it fulfills the wishes of all. Therefore it is declared: "Raining down from the sky all the precious things — elephants and the rest — the shower of all the seven precious gems" means the shower of the seven precious gems. For this purpose Tārā arises as the one victorious over the three worlds.

"Extremely faint in diligence" means laziness and the like. The yoga of power is the yoga of renown. Therefore, purification through the yoga of power is purification through the yoga of heroic force. Through the application of diligence: for this purpose, through the purification of the yoga of power, the supreme horse arises — meaning Hayagrīva.

"Four shoulders and four arms" is like one who has eight arms. "Four feet" refers to the posture of extending the left leg. Then with the first of the right feet he presses down the goddess Śrī of human attainments. With the second he presses down the goddess Śāci and Ratī. With the first of the left feet he presses down the three-eyed one and Viṣṇu. With the second he presses down Brahmā and the god of desire, and so he stands.

The lord of all attainments, the supreme horse: gathering the three worlds together — the Great God (Śiva) and those like him — and having all three go for refuge and the like, what has thoroughly subdued them, and by means of Vajrahūmkāra having liberated all three worlds entirely —

Within that maṇḍala, the Great God (Śiva) presented to the teacher an offering meant to reverse adversity, and from that offering was extracted the following: just as the lines are to be drawn in a square with four gates in due

order, so it is a maṇḍala filled completely with Gāyatrī and the like — that is the meaning of the word "maṇḍala."

As to the measure of the maṇḍala by which the lines are to be drawn: "one cubit within" means one cubit at the center, and one cubit on the outside, while the third additional measure is to be understood as meaning two cubits. "Like a lunar disc" means that the inner core of the maṇḍala is round — so did the Blessed One declare in the maṇḍala that liberates the three worlds.

Now the meditation on the unfavorable side and the meditation on the side of awakening shall be explained. In this regard, first: improper attention is the cause of conditioned existence, and it is the cause of entering the Four Noble Truths through delusion. Cultivating the close placement of mindfulness with respect to the body is meditating on what is improper with regard to the body; by thoroughly examining it, one enters into the truth of suffering. Improper attention to that — because it bears the characteristic mark of formations — is improper attention directed toward the suffering of formations. Together with that, one regards whatever suffering arises in situations that include what is undefiled; and feeling, being the cause of craving, is examined thoroughly, and thereby one enters into the truth of the origin of suffering. By thoroughly examining the mind that clings to what belongs to a self, one enters into the truth of cessation. By cutting off the view of self one arrives at understanding, and by examining phenomena one enters into the truth of the path — for one is without delusion with regard to all defiled and purified phenomena. In this way, because one enters the Four Noble Truths from the very beginning, the cultivation of the close placement of mindfulness is to be established. Then, having thoroughly understood the cultivation of right abandonment, and having understood it in all its aspects on both the favorable and unfavorable sides, one undertakes these four kinds of diligence. Having cultivated the close placement of mindfulness and thoroughly understood all aspects of the favorable and unfavorable sides, in order to thoroughly understand the favorable side and thoroughly understand the unfavorable side, one undertakes the four kinds of diligence — as was stated extensively above: "in order to abandon evil, unwholesome phenomena that have arisen" and so forth.

"Remaining in the very activity" means: in order to correctly understand all objects therein, one abandons the five faults and relies upon the eight formations — and so, through the cultivation of diligence with full understanding, it is the very activity of the mind abiding. As for the four legs of

miraculous power: because they are the cause of the complete growth of all aims, "abiding" here is to be understood as meditative absorption of the mind. Then, at the culmination of right abandonment, those legs of miraculous power are likewise the very activity — to be understood through abandoning the five faults and cultivating the eight formations.

What are the five faults? The Blessed One declared: laziness, lack of vigilance, dullness, sinking, and agitation — together with non-application and over-application: these five are enumerated as the five faults to be abandoned. In this regard, sinking and agitation constitute one fault: non-application is a fault at the time when sinking and agitation are operative; over-application, when one is thoroughly pacified, is for the purpose of abandoning these. As to how one abandons them and establishes the eight formations: the four that abandon laziness — aspiration, effort, faith, and pliancy — are to be understood in due order. Abiding, and then sustained abiding, and

The characteristic and the fruit of that very thing are as follows: the ground of abiding is aspiration; abiding itself is effort. The characteristic that is the ground of aspiration is faith — that is, trusting conviction, faith proper, and desire. The fruit of abiding through effort is pliancy; and this is to be understood as the distinction of meditative absorption accompanied by aspiration-based diligence.

The four formations for abandoning the remainder are mindfulness, vigilance, intention, and equanimity — each the antidote to the four faults in corresponding order. This, too, is to be understood in accordance with the sequence of mindfulness and the rest. The object of focus — by virtue of non-dullness — is to be discerned through sinking and agitation; and the thorough application regarding those two arises from pliancy through the pacification of what energizes them. Mindfulness, when focusing on the object, is vigilance free from dullness; when one has become free from dullness, sinking and agitation are discerned. The purpose is that what has not been discerned may come to be discerned. Through the intention that actively applies itself, sinking and agitation are quieted; and through the mind of supreme pliancy in thoroughgoing pacification, equanimity.

Now, how should one set forth the presentation of the five faculties — faith and the rest — at the conclusion of the bases of miraculous ability (Skt. *ṛddhipāda*)? That which, being endowed with the liberating factor, is master of

aspiration's yoga, and, when focused on the object, is master of non-forgetfulness free from dullness — that is called master. The activity of the bases of miraculous ability is the engagement of the mind. That which is endowed with the liberating factor is: master of aspiration toward the roots of virtue; master of thorough application; master of the object free from dullness; master of non-forgetfulness; and master of discrimination. The five faculties — faith and the rest — are to be understood in due sequential order.

Thereupon, regarding the Blessed One's teaching that the eater and the eaten are empty: beginning from the inner sense bases, one sees the emptiness of outer food, the emptiness of that body's eater and eaten, and also the emptiness of that body that has been consecrated — and through weariness with this, one abandons formations. Because virtue is inexhaustible and is viewed with especial distinction, this is spoken of as the emptiness of inner and outer. Because the container-world, the vessel in which things abide, is vast and expansive, its emptiness is spoken of as great emptiness. Moreover, the emptiness of that by which one sees emptiness — whether inner sense bases or the rest — through the wisdom of emptiness itself, is the emptiness of emptiness. The emptiness seen as it appears from the perspective of ultimate reality is ultimate emptiness. The bodhisattva practices precisely for the sake of that.

Now, how is the meaning of that emptiness to be sought? The Blessed One declared: for the purpose of attaining the two virtues — the conditioned (Skt. *saṃskṛta*) virtuous and the unconditioned (Skt. *asaṃskṛta*) — and for the sake of constantly benefiting sentient beings, and for the sake of supremely benefiting sentient beings, by not abandoning *saṃsāra*, the emptiness of that is the emptiness of beginning- and end-lessness. One grows weary upon seeing *saṃsāra* as empty without interruption, and although one would thoroughly abandon *saṃsāra*, because virtue is inexhaustible, viewing it with especial distinction, one does not enter *nirvāṇa* and does not abandon that emptiness. This is the emptiness free from acceptance and rejection. Regarding the phrase "because lineage is perfectly pure": lineage is intrinsic nature, essential identity. Regarding the phrase "for the sake of attaining the major and minor marks": it is in order to attain the major marks and minor marks of a great being, and in order to purify the Dharmas of a buddha, that bodhisattvas engage in practice — and in particular, the powers and

fearlessness and so forth — and in order to train in these. For now, one should understand that emptiness is set forth in fourteen aspects.

Now, what is emptiness in this context? Emptiness is the absence of any ultimate entity in phenomena and in persons. Therefore, the ultimate entity that arises from that absence — the emptiness of the absence of an ultimate entity in those very phenomena and persons — is one kind. And the ultimate entity arising from the emptiness of the absence of an ultimate entity in phenomena and persons on the other side is another kind.

As has been said, in order to explain the defining marks of the sixteen emptinesses — because things such as depth and so forth are empty — two systems set forth emptiness. These are the emptiness of absence of entity and the emptiness of the intrinsic nature of the absence of entity. In order to comprehensively abandon all the forms of emptiness that arise in engaging with phenomena and persons in a correct manner, one should understand the subdivisions of emptiness according to their sequential order.

How is this to be established and known? If this were not defiled throughout, then all embodied beings would be liberated. If this were not purified, then any effort undertaken would be fruitless. If the emptiness of phenomena were not defiled — because adventitious defilement has not arisen — in the sense that emptiness does not become corrupted through defilement by adverse conditions, then, since defilement itself would have no entity, all sentient beings would be liberated without any effort. But then, since that which is unarisen is also not purified by adverse conditions, any effort undertaken for the sake of liberation would be fruitless.

Proceeding in this way, because the intrinsic nature of mind is luminosity, it is neither afflicted nor unafflicted, neither pure nor impure. How then is it that it is neither afflicted nor defiled? Because affliction is adventitious. Similarly, how is it that it is neither unafflicted nor pure? Because of that very adventitious nature of affliction. This is what is expressed through the subdivisions of emptiness. By that, the condensed meaning of emptiness has been established.

It is further said: as the antidote to attachment, there is meditation on unattractiveness and the like; as the antidote to aversion, there is loving-kindness; and as the antidote to delusion, there is dependent origination.

How does one reverse attachment? If it is by means of what contradicts attachment, that is partly so. Yet one who takes the very nature of attachment as its own essence becomes thereby free from attachment. Just as it is said:

the Blessed One declared, "How wondrous, son of good family! The gnosis of desire in all buddhas is without turbidity. Through desire itself, desire is overcome, and all happiness is bestowed. Attachment and the like are by nature free from any intrinsic fault."

Otherwise, if one who has found attachment while abiding on the path of a stream-enterer continues to act without completely abandoning that attachment and the like, a difference in qualities will nonetheless arise from the distinction in levels of purification. As an example: when the fragrant ketaka flower is consumed by a superior elephant, it becomes a substance like musk and the like; whereas when consumed by an ordinary elephant, it becomes a substance like dung. Therefore the fault lies not with the ketaka flower itself.

In the same way, attachment and the like, when one abides on a level of purified progression and applies them through the distinctive engagement of superior intention, ripen the fruit of a supremely distinguished result. As an example: when milk is drunk by a snake or the like, it becomes a poisonous substance; but when drunk by a human being, it arises as a nectarous substance.

In this way, son of good family, because attachment and the like are without fault by virtue of the distinctive nature of intention, applying them produces the fruit of a supremely distinguished result. In whatever way one is endowed with the qualities of a stream that has become especially elevated, the fruit of that particular stream arises as especially elevated. For example, the intrinsic nature of attachment and the like, when one abides on the especially elevated progression of those such as the ketaka flower and so on, is perfectly pure.

Here ends the glorious Great Royal Tantra called Śrī Sampuṭa-tilaka.

This was translated and edited by the Indian paṇḍita Kāyastha Gāyadhara and the Tibetan translator, the monk Śākya Yeshe, and established in its definitive form. Subsequently, certain other Tibetan translators made alterations that did not accord with others' translations, inserted their own names, suppressed the names of others, and committed various errors. In order to expose those errors and those who committed them, it was later collated once more against the four Indian tantras and, by that same monk Śākya Yeshe himself, corrected and established in its definitive form.

Translator's Notes

- The opening colophon phrase "Kongba examined and made revisions" likely refers to a Tibetan editor or scholar named Kongba (Tib. Kongba), whose identity is not established from context alone; this is a scribal note appended to a preceding section rather than part of the main text.

The term "bindus within bindus" renders བཞི་མཆོག་གི་མཆོག་པོ་, a technical tantric term (Skt. bindu). In tantric context, bindu refers to the subtle drops of the vajra body, and the locative construction "within bindus" points to a nested or concentrated meaning that the questioner is asking to have clarified.

The phrase བཞི་མཆོག་གི་སྐད་ཀྱི་སྐད་, rendered "language of the outcast peoples," refers to the deliberate intentional or twilight language (Skt. sandhyābhāṣā or apabhraṃśa) associated with tribal or marginal populations; some scholars read this as indicating that "secret" is a term drawn from non-Sanskrit vernacular speech used in tantric circles.

Āli and Kāli (ཨ་ལི་དང་ཀ་ལི་) refer to the vowels and consonants of the Sanskrit alphabet as used in tantric practice; they are kept in their standard Sanskrit form.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation reproduces this exactly as the text is incomplete at that point.

- The phrase rendered "victory-bow" for བཞི་མཆོག་གི་ཐུག་པོ་ is uncertain; ཐུག་ can mean "bow" (a weapon) or possibly refer to a yogic posture, and བཞི་མཆོག་ (vijaya, "victorious") may be a proper name or epithet. The precise referent is unclear without further context from the root tantra.

The goddess name བཞི་མཆོག་གི་ཐུག་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་ is a complex epithet; I have rendered it descriptively as "the goddess Durgatiprasāmanī who possesses the dhāraṇī," though this is an interpretive approximation of a likely Sanskrit name meaning something like "the beautiful dhāraṇī-holder who repels difficulty."

The final sentence breaks off mid-thought, as it does in the source; this appears to be a continuation passage.

- The passage is a running commentary — likely a tantra commentary in the Yoginī-tantra tradition — on a root text. Several technical epithets appear as tantric deity names: Heruka, the Lord of the Lotus Dance (Padmanartesvara), Vajrasūrya (Vajra Sun), and the Supreme Horse (Hayagrīva) are cited as ritual objects corresponding to the afflictions of aversion, desire, miserliness, and laziness respectively; the exact mapping in the Tibetan is slightly compressed and the assignment of which deity corresponds to which affliction is not fully disambiguated in this passage.

The phrase rendered "ultimate contentment of mind" (mchog tu yid srub pa) is an unusual compound; "srub pa" can suggest stirring, churning, or deep satisfaction — the sense here is of the mind being thoroughly suffused or gratified to the utmost. This rendering follows the contextual interpretation supported by the parallelism with bliss and the goddess retinue.

- The phrase rendered "essential-nature body" translates svabhāvakāya, the fourth kāya sometimes enumerated alongside the three bodies; the Tibetan ngobonyid kyi sku confirms this technical term. The passage reflects a Vajrayāna tantric commentary context in which the five buddhas are identified with the five wisdoms and Vajrasattva is presented as their quintessence and ground. The nine aspects mentioned alongside "emanation" (sprul pa) likely refer to the nine-limbed or nine-aspect body of the saṃbhogakāya as enumerated in certain Yoginītantra commentarial traditions; the precise enumeration is left unspecified in the passage itself.

- The passage operates within a Yoginī tantra commentarial framework in which the eight

consciousnesses of the Yogācāra system are identified with the eight Vajradevīs, and their transformation into the four wisdoms is the doctrinal engine of the argument. "Akṣobhya and the rest" renders འཁོབ་ཡི་ཐུག་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ལྟ་བུ་, the Tathāgata Akṣobhya being paradigmatic for bodhic embodiment without physical form. The remark about "barbarians" (Tib. kla klo, Skt. mleccha) criticizing or misusing the term dākinī by reducing it to the literal sense of "sky-goer" reflects a standard move in tantric commentaries distinguishing the inner, doctrinal meaning from popular or outsider usage.

- The syllable "saṃ" referenced toward the end appears to be a mantra syllable or seed-syllable (bīja) whose specific tantric referent is being glossed — the text is explaining why a particular syllable in a mantra or title encodes the meaning of union with all buddhas. This is consistent with tantric commentary style but the precise mantra being analyzed is not specified in this excerpt.

The final sentence on "not empty" is a compressed Yogācāra-inflected argument: conventionally imputed (falsely imagined, parikalpita) entities are real as falsely imagined entities, so one cannot say the three realms are empty of them — an affirmation of the dependent reality of conventional phenomena. The philosophical density here is genuine; the rendering follows the Tibetan closely.

- The phrase rendered "non-abiding nirvāṇa" (apratīṣṭhitanirvāṇa) is a doctrinal inference from the Tibetan "mi gnas pa'i mya ngan las 'das pa," which is standard for this technical Mahāyāna concept.

The "seven aspects of greatness" is a reference to the sevenfold greatness of the Mahāyāna as enumerated in Asaṅga's Mahāyānasamgraha; this is assumed known to the intended audience and is not glossed in the body.

- The phrase rendered "the gnosis of Viṣṇu that pervades all things" translates "khyab 'jug gi ye shes kyi bdag nyid skyes bu," where "khyab 'jug" is the standard Tibetan rendering of Viṣṇu. The passage is situating Viṣṇu as an example of a non-Buddhist conception of a pervasive self — mirroring the immediately following treatment of Śiva — so the reference is polemical and comparative, not endorsing the view.

The inner sea (rol mtsho) from which the great rivers flow is a cosmological feature of classical Buddhist geography, here used as an analogy for the undivided dharmadhātu.

- The passage shifts from philosophical commentary on suchness into dense Vajrayāna tantric exegesis. The anatomical discussion of the "secret lotus," channels, and the five spaces reflects inner-heat and subtle-body yoga terminology that is intentionally cryptic; the translation follows the Tibetan closely without harmonizing it into a single consistent physiological system, since the text itself offers alternative interpretations.

The phrase rendered "five spaces" for "nam mkha' lnga" refers to the five elements conceived as spatial or ethereal constituents in the tantric subtle-body system, not simply to the element space alone.

The "sixth" wisdom discussed in the verse section is a genuinely obscure doctrinal point. The text asserts that beyond the five Sugatas (the five buddha families, each associated with a mirror-like gnosis and so forth) there is a sixth, identified as "glorious great bliss," but immediately qualifies that this sixth is not named in the hundred-thousand-section tantra. This reflects an intra-tantric debate about whether a sixth buddha or sixth gnosis is posited; the translation preserves the tension without resolving it.

- The passage is a highly technical tantric commentary combining physiology, cosmology, mantra-theory, and lexical glosses. Several terms are proper names of ritual substances or plants rendered in transliteration following the Tibetan phonetic equivalents, as the Sanskrit

identifications are either transparent or uncertain enough that invention would be misleading. The term "bhaga" is retained as a Sanskrit technical term for the sacred generative aperture, standard in tantric physiological contexts. The final sentence breaks off mid-list, mirroring an incomplete or transitional point in the source text. The identifications of ritual substances such as dharu-ra, citraka, karavīra, arka, and kacchara follow standard Āyurvedic and tantric lexical traditions; some remain provisional given the cryptic register of the text.

- The passage is a lexical-glossary section of a tantric ritual text — likely a commentary or exegetical appendix explaining technical and coded terms, many of which are Sanskrit loanwords transliterated into Tibetan. Several plant and substance identifications reflect traditional Āyurvedic and tantric dravyaguṇa nomenclature and are rendered according to standard identifications in the literature; some identifications such as "kosha" for rice-water, "ruta" for the chief of diseases, and "balaka" remain specialist technical terms best left in their reconstructed Sanskrit forms.

The phrase rendered as "the twice-born is a brahmin" reflects the standard Sanskrit dvija category.

The eye-salve passage may describe a ritual for achieving visionary transformation; the language "takes on the form of a god" and "sees oneself as one truly is" likely carries tantric soteriological weight beyond mere cosmetic application.

- The passage is a dense glossary of cryptic or coded terms, typical of tantric or Āyurvedic-adjacent ritual literature in which outer terms serve as cover-language for materials used in ritual compounds, eye-ointments, and other preparations. Several entries are internally consistent but their Sanskrit originals are only partially recoverable; the transliteration "Srotāñjana" for སྐྱུ་མཚན་མཚན་ follows the obvious Sanskrit reading (srotāñjana, a collyrium). The term "Krānta overpowers Viṣṇu" (ཀློང་མཚན་ = Skt. krānta, possibly Viṣṇukrānta, a well-known medicinal plant associated with Viṣṇu) is rendered literally; the plant name Viṣṇukrānta is likely intended. "Citā wood" renders མཚན་མཚན་, where citā (Skt. citā) is the funeral pyre, though here "the fire of citā wood" most plausibly refers to the wood of the funeral pyre used ritually. The phrase translated "the lunar mark" (མཚན་མཚན་) consistently refers to menstrual blood in this context, as in the preceding passage. The entry "honey" appears twice with different glosses (bee-honey and yaṣṭi-honey), which appears to be two separate but adjacent glossary entries, not an error in translation.

- The passage is a technical ritual commentary on a Yoga Tantra text, containing a dense series of lexical glosses that equate Sanskrit botanical, mineralogical, and ritual terms with their Indic equivalents. Many of the Sanskrit plant names in the gloss list (nrpa as "king of bees," vakuci, keśari, śyāmā, etc.) are technical Āyurvedic and tantric botanical identifications; the renderings follow the Tibetan explanatory glosses as literally as possible. Where the Tibetan gloss itself uses a transliterated Sanskrit term without further explanation, I have retained the Sanskrit.

The verse section at the end describes a fivefold typology of weapons and their corresponding mudrās, likely drawn from a ritual combat or subjugation practice. The term rendered "mechanical device" for མཚན་མཚན་ (yantra) refers to a catapult or similar apparatus. "The Vedic knowledge of the bow" renders མཚན་མཚན་ and alludes to the Dhanurveda, the traditional science of archery.

The mantra strings have been transcribed as they appear in the Tibetan, regularized to standard IAST without alteration of the syllables, which are themselves Sanskrit phonemic transcriptions in Tibetan script.

- The term "Vaiśākhā" appears as a named posture and is a technical term for a specific standing or foot position in both martial and yogic contexts; its exact physical configuration is

being described in the surrounding verses, and the name is preserved as a proper technical term here.

The phrase rendered as "twenty-six finger-widths" follows the Tibetan "sor mo nyi shu rtsa drug chad" literally; it may refer to a standard measurement unit in the context of posture or weapon craft rather than an anatomical severing.

The final prose passage is somewhat compressed and elliptical; "the hand of the vessel" and "the mother goddess" (rendered from "bum pa'i lag pa ma'i ma mo") follow the literal Tibetan, which describes a specific ritual scenario involving a vase empowerment and feminine deity figure. The exact referent of "ma mo" here could be a specific class of goddess or the generic term for a wrathful mother deity; both are possible in tantric context.

- The term rendered "stub" in "without a stub" and "with a second stub" translates *śrubs*, a technical term referring to the prongs of a vajra implement — a single-pointed vajra versus a two-pointed one. This is a tantric instrumental distinction that the commentary is specifying contextually.

The phrase *thāb-sbyor* rendered "amṛta combined with skillful means" could alternatively refer to a specific ritual substance preparation; the exact referent is somewhat obscure and may be a technical tantric term for a particular yoga or substance combination.

The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text is incomplete at this point.

- The names of the eight nāgas as listed in this text do not perfectly match the standard canonical enumeration, and one name rendered here as "Vāsukī's son" is a contextual interpretation of a compound that could alternatively refer to a distinct nāga name; the Tibetan is slightly compressed at that point. The repeated figure "Acala, the Immovable Lord" is the bodhisattva Acala (Tibetan: Mi g.yo ba), distinct from the more commonly known Acalanātha of East Asian traditions, though related; the gloss "Immovable Lord" is retained throughout for consistency. Seed-syllables and bīja mantras have been retained untranslated as is standard practice in tantric ritual literature.

- The passage is a tantric ritual commentary of considerable technical density. The rendering of 男男男男 throughout as "men" or "of men" follows the grammatical context where it contrasts with 女女女女 (women) later and refers to male human beings. The garuḍa episode, the fire-offering section, and the final union passage all belong to a single continuous exegetical commentary on a root tantra; the translation preserves this structure without adding subheadings, as required. "Akṣobhya and so on" renders 阿闍世王阿闍世王阿闍世王 — Akṣobhya is the standard identification of that epithet.

- The passage is a dense ritual manual describing maṇḍala construction and consecration rites. The figures Caṇḍā (here rendered from drag mo, "the fierce one") and Anantā and Vijayā are names of specific stake-goddesses used in maṇḍala boundary rites; these are kept in their doctrinal roles without further gloss as they are technical proper names. The term "five outflows" in the opening refers to the standard Tantric enumeration of bodily substances connected with the five elements. The phrase "the first syllable of its name" is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan and may refer to the bīja-syllable associated with the deity of that station; this is a routine ritual instruction rather than a consequential textual uncertainty.

- The term *murja* rendered without change is a transliteration of a Sanskrit term (likely Skt. *mūrja* or a related deity name) whose precise identification in the context of this maṇḍala arrangement is uncertain; it appears to be one of the corner-guardian goddesses and is left as a proper name accordingly.

The phrase rendered "the goddess of permanence and so forth" refers to the goddesses associated with permanence, bliss, self, and purity — the four qualities often attributed to

nirvāṇa and personified as deities in Vajrayāna maṇḍalas — but the text gives only "permanence and so forth" without listing all four, so they are not expanded here.

The passage "the first vowel" and "the vowel following the first" likely refers to a Sanskrit vowel sequence used ritually, with each vowel associated with a particular empowerment object; the precise system depends on which tantra's vowel series is being applied, and this is left as given in the text.

- The term rendered "vajra hook" for "rdo rje su tsi ka" is a hapax-like compound; "sucika" in Sanskrit means a needle or pin, and in tantric iconography it typically refers to a ritual hook implement. The rendering "vajra hook" is standard in comparable iconographic literature.

The phrase "substance of accomplishment" renders "bsgrub par bya ba btung bar bya" — literally "the thing-to-be-accomplished is to be drunk," a standard tantric euphemism for the ritual consumption of the accomplishment substance (siddhi-dravya), typically a fluid offered in the skull-cup.

The description of Heruka's iconography here (eight faces, four feet, sixteen arms, twenty-four eyes) follows standard Cakrasaṃvara-cycle iconography, and the text oscillates between this full form and a condensed four-faced, four-armed form, which is a recognized exoteric/esoteric variant.

- The phrase rendered "the cell of the non-true" in the preceding passage corresponds to the present "cell of power" for the same directional cell; this reflects the Tibetan dbang ldan, meaning "endowed with power" or "the powerful one," which is consistent with tantric directional schema. The two renderings reflect slightly different contextual emphases in the preceding and present segments.

The passage describing the actions of the various female tantric figures (Ghasmarī, Pukkasī, the robber woman, and so forth) employs highly compressed tantric diction in which the activities described are to be understood as ritual and meditative operations within the framework of the Hevajra or related Yoginītantra system, not necessarily as literal physical acts.

The final sentence breaks off mid-thought in the Tibetan, corresponding to the natural continuation into the next passage.

- The passage is a tantric ritual commentary, likely on the Hevajra or a related Yoginī tantra, explaining symbolic correspondences of maṇḍala shapes, ritual implements, empowerment procedures, and seed-syllables. The phrase rendered "the covered painted form of various kinds" is a technical term for painted deity images used as supports for visualization practice; the Tibetan is somewhat compressed and the precise ritual context shapes the reading. The term "EVAM" is kept in Sanskrit as it is a standard tantric technical term (the syllables E and VAM representing the union of wisdom and means). The syllables YUM, KHAM, OM, and KAṂ are seed-syllables retained untranslated as is conventional. The phrase "fish-skin" likely refers to a specific ritual implement or material used in the middling empowerment, and its exact referent in the ritual tradition is uncertain.

- The phrase rendered "in the manner of remaining in the form of three stamens" is a technically unusual image. The Tibetan reads "ming po gsum gyi gzugs kyis gnas pa'i tshul gyis" — three stamens or pistils in floral symbolism — likely referring to the three parts of a lotus stamen as an esoteric anatomical or iconographic symbol. The precise referent is uncertain without the root tantra context.

The final sentence is incomplete in the source passage, breaking off mid-thought; this has been rendered accordingly as an open construction.

- The passage is a dense commentarial gloss, likely on a Vajrayāna ritual or sādhana text,

moving rapidly through identifications of deity-forms, epithets, and doctrinal correspondences. The name "Padmanartteśvara" renders Tibetan "pad+ma gar gyi dbang phyug," meaning "lord of the lotus dance," a form of Avalokiteśvara. The goddess names "Śāci" and "Ratī" are the consorts of Indra and Kāma respectively; Śāci is rendered from Tibetan "lha mo sha tsi" and Ratī from "dga' ma." "Vajrahūṃkāra" renders "rdo rje hūṃ mdzad kyi," a wrathful deity whose name means "he who makes the vajra hūṃ-sound." The passage breaks off mid-sentence as given.

- The term rendered "Gāyatrī and the like" for རྒྱལ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ refers to the goddess Gāyatrī and similar figures who fill the maṇḍala; the Sanskrit name is preserved rather than translating the Tibetan gloss. The passage on the five faults and eight formations draws on the standard Yogācāra analysis of meditative cultivation as found in Maitreya's Madhyāntavibhāga and related sources. The closing sentence is incomplete in the source text as provided; the translation ends where the Tibetan breaks off.
- The passage moves through a dense scholastic enumeration — likely a commentary on an Abhidharma or Mahāyāna treatise dealing with the path of meditation — and the section on the various emptinesses reflects a standard Mahāyāna typology (inner emptiness, outer emptiness, great emptiness, emptiness of emptiness, ultimate emptiness, emptiness of beginninglessness and endlessness, emptiness free from acceptance and rejection). The Tibetan term rendered "master" (ལྷ་མོ་) literally means "lord" or "controller" and here designates the dominant function of each faculty. The passage ends mid-sentence; the translation preserves this.
- The passage "the emptiness of absence of entity and the emptiness of the intrinsic nature of the absence of entity" reflects a standard Madhyamaka scholastic distinction; the two Tibetan terms rendered are dngos po med pa stong pa nyid and dngos po med pa'i rang bzhin stong pa nyid respectively, corresponding to what in many texts are listed among the sixteen or eighteen emptinesses.

The quotation attributed to the Blessed One regarding the gnosis of desire in all buddhas reflects a Vajrayāna doctrinal register — the idea that the passions, in their purified aspect, are wisdom — and is likely drawn from a tantric or quasi-tantric source embedded in a Madhyamaka or Yogācāra śāstra context. This is a genuinely significant doctrinal point worth flagging for listeners with a solely Sūtrayāna background.

The ketaka flower is a fragrant blossom well attested in Indian literature as an example used in Buddhist śāstras to illustrate how the same substance produces different results depending on the vessel or agent receiving it.

- The phrase rendered "stream that has become especially elevated" translates a somewhat compressed passage about khyad par du 'phags pa'i rgyun gyi dngos po, literally "the entity of a stream that is especially elevated." The sense is that whichever elevated continuum of practice one is endowed with, the corresponding result is correspondingly elevated. The phrasing is deliberately parallel to the ketaka-flower analogy developed in the preceding passage.

The colophon's reference to "the four Indian tantras" likely means the four root tantras of the Sampuṭa cycle used as the editorial standard for this revision. The precise identity of these four is a matter for specialists and is not specified in the text itself.

Colophon

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human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.